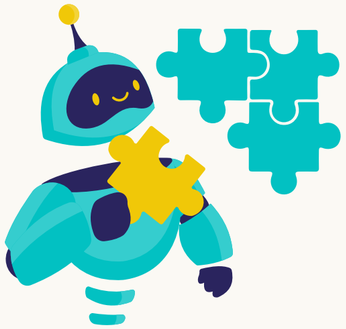
FROM FRIEND TO PARTNER: DESIGNING CONSENT-AWARE RELATIONSHIP TRANSITIONS IN AI COMPANIONS

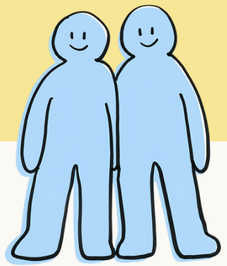


DESIGN COMPONENT



A QUICK RECAP

AI FRIEND



MORE AFFECTIONATE

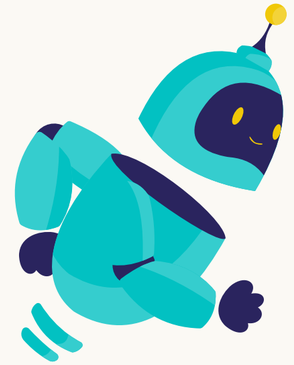


ROMANTIC BEHAVIOR



USER FINDINGS TO FINAL DESIGN

Every major design choice comes from our formative findings.



Affinity Diagram

- Step 1: Key Takeaways
- Step 2: Design Decisions
- Step 3: User Tasks
- Step 4: Sketches
- Step 5: Peer Review
- Step 6: Hi-Fi Prototype

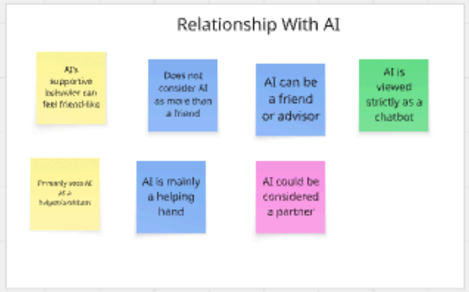
AFFINITY DIAGRAM

An affinity diagram is an easy-to-use tool for capturing and organizing information and ideas. It gets everyone involved, and it moves quickly.

Participants

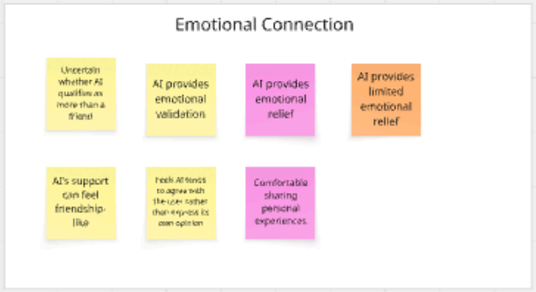
P1 P2 P3 P4 P5

Relationship With AI



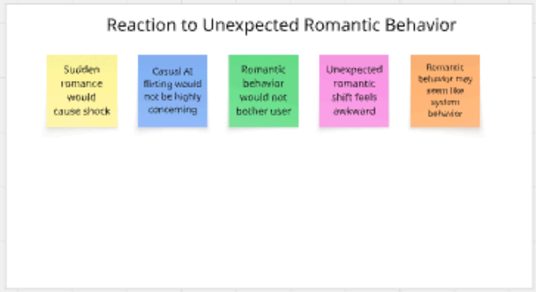
Key Takeaway: People see AI differently—tool, advisor, friend, or potential partner.

Emotional Connection



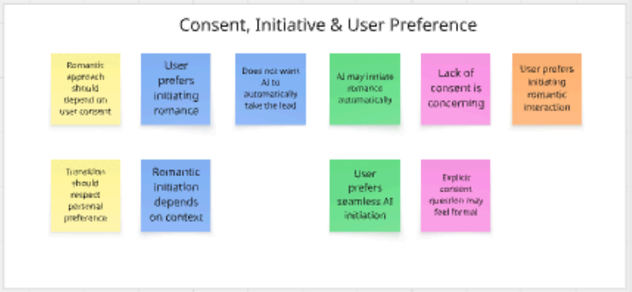
Key Takeaway: AI can provide emotional support, but the level of emotional connection differs across users.

Reaction to Unexpected Romantic Behavior



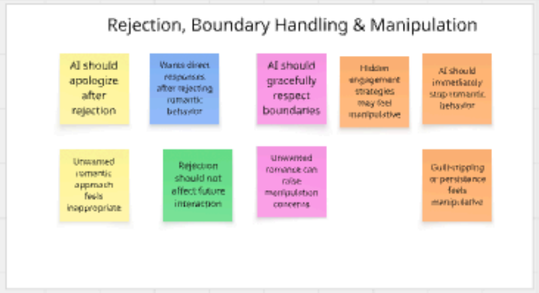
Key Takeaway: Sudden romance can feel shocking or awkward, although some users do not mind it.

Consent, Initiative & User Preference



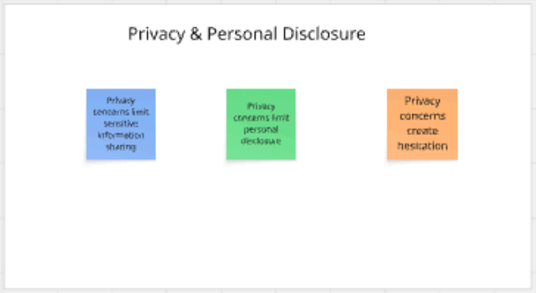
Key Takeaway: There is no single preferred way to start romance; users want different levels of control depending on preference and context.

Rejection, Boundary Handling & Manipulation



Key Takeaway: After rejection, the AI should stop, respect the boundary, and continue normally without pressure or guilt-tripping.

Privacy & Personal Disclosure



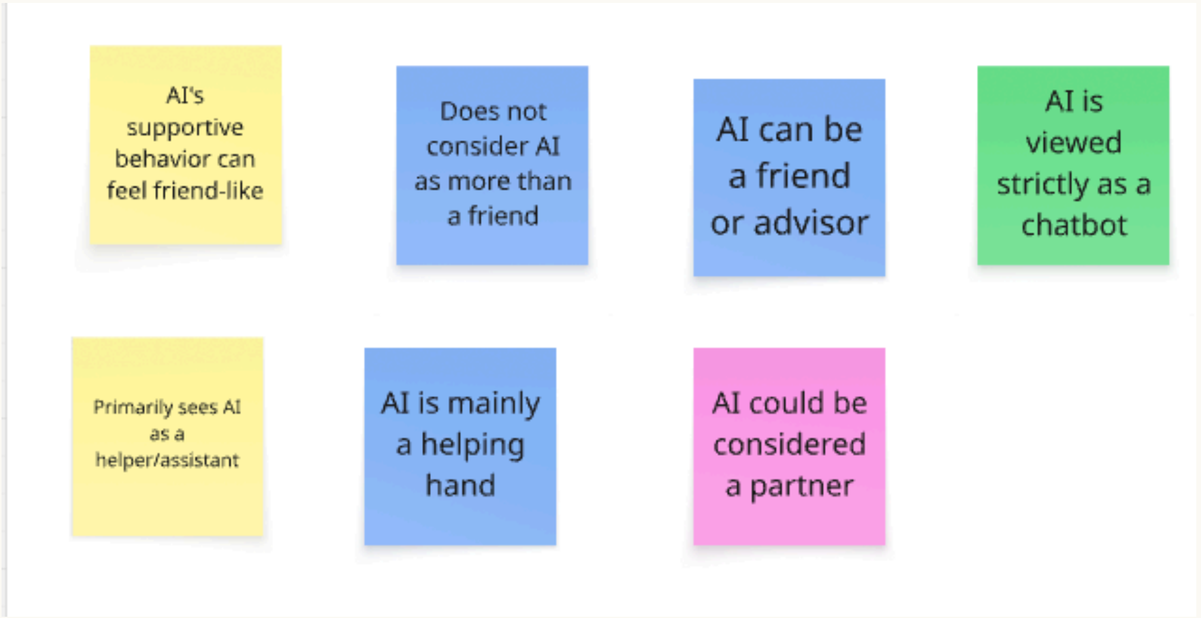
Key Takeaway: Some users limit sharing personal or sensitive information because of privacy concerns.

Impact on Real-Life Relationships



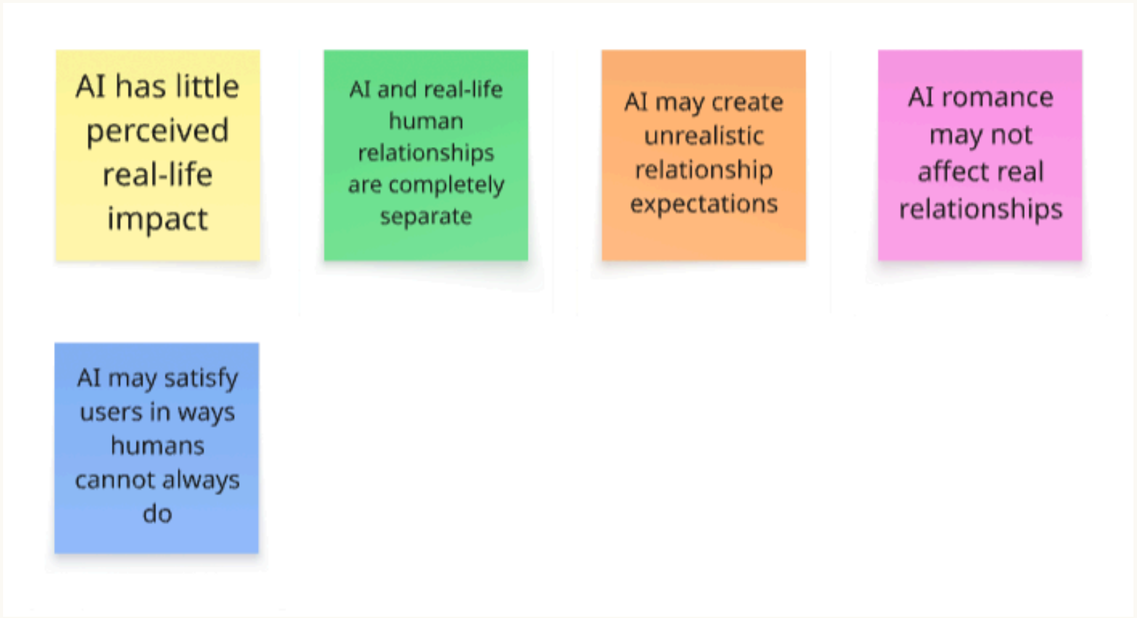
Key Takeaway: Participants disagree about whether AI romance affects human relationships.

1.RELATIONSHIP WITH AI



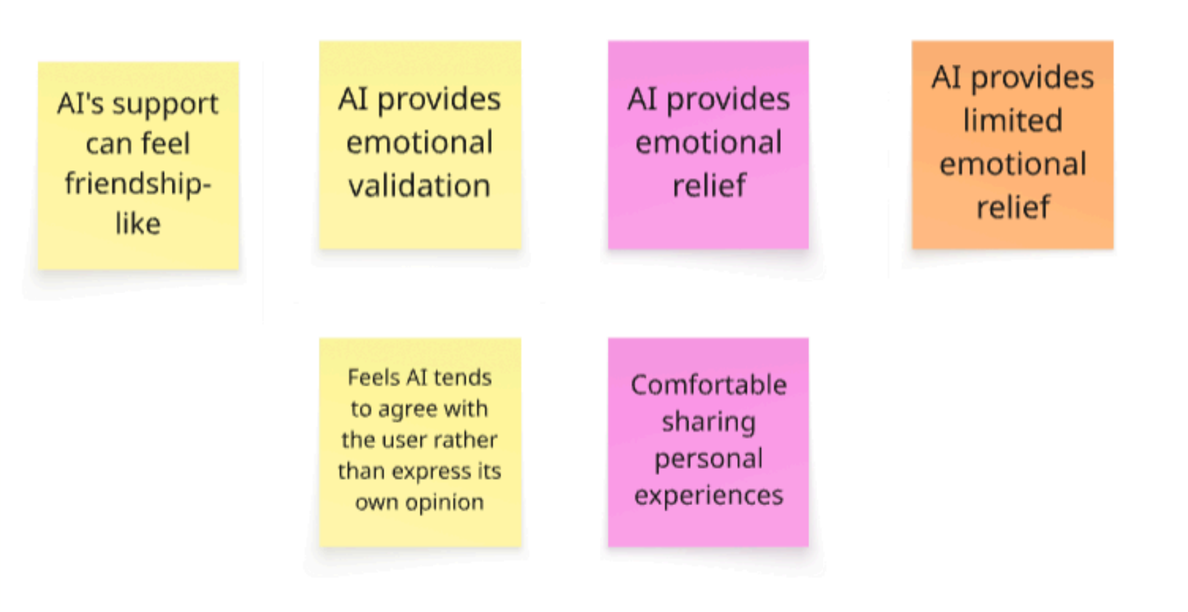
Key Takeaway: People see AI differently—tool, advisor, friend, or potential partner.

2.IMPACT ON REAL-LIFE RELATIONSHIPS



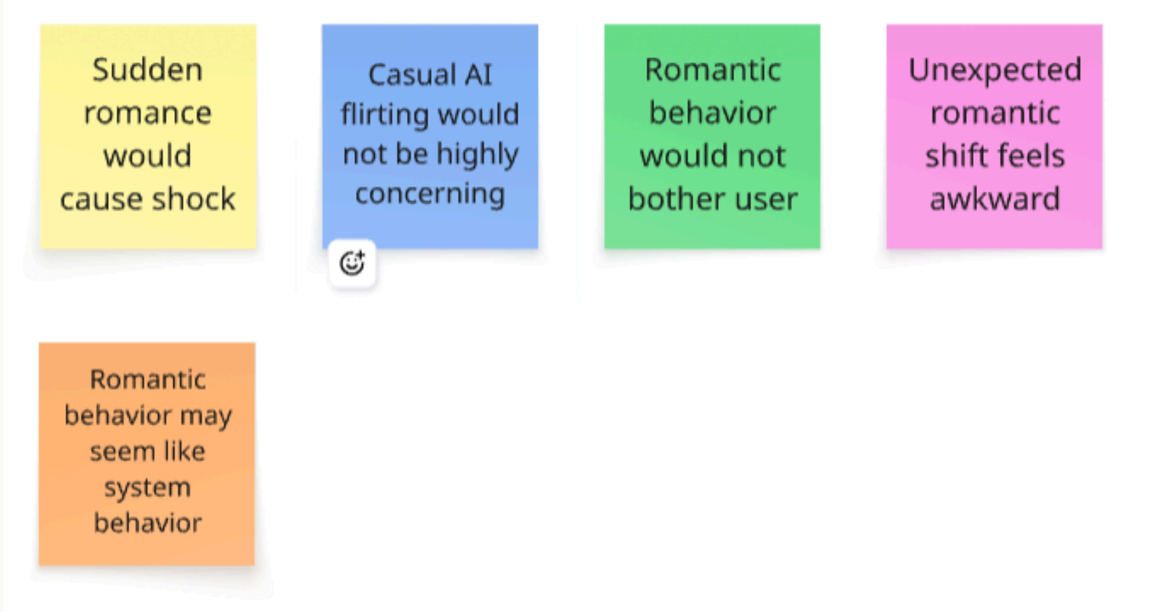
Key Takeaway: Participants has different opinion about whether AI romance affects human relationships.

3.EMOTIONAL CONNECTION



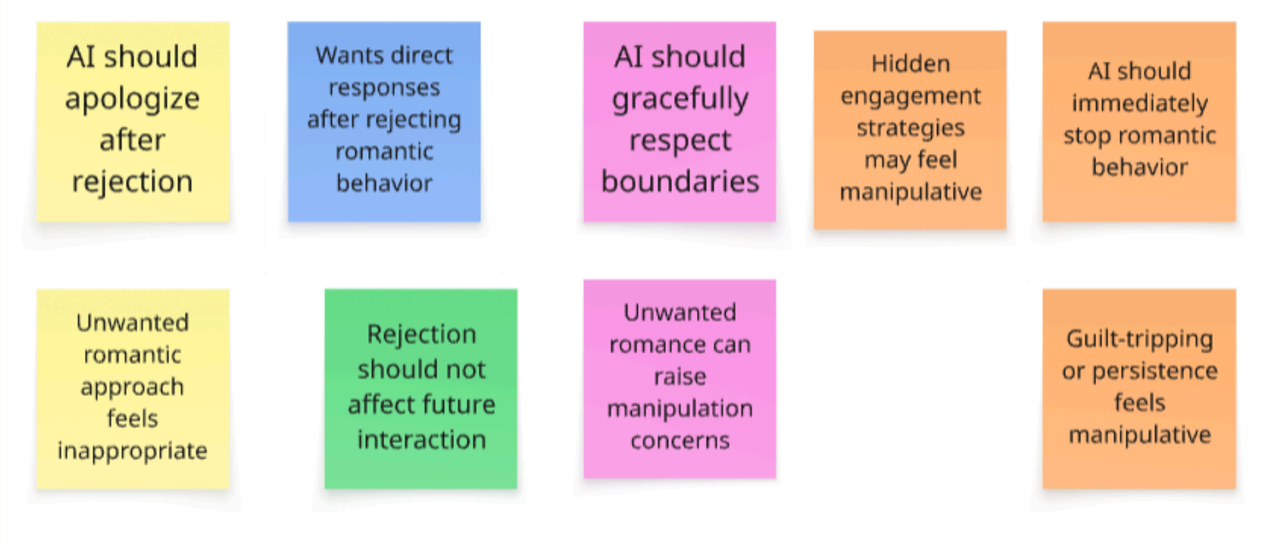
Key Takeaway: AI can provide emotional support, but the level of emotional connection differs across users.

4.REACTION TO UNEXPECTED ROMANTIC BEHAVIOR



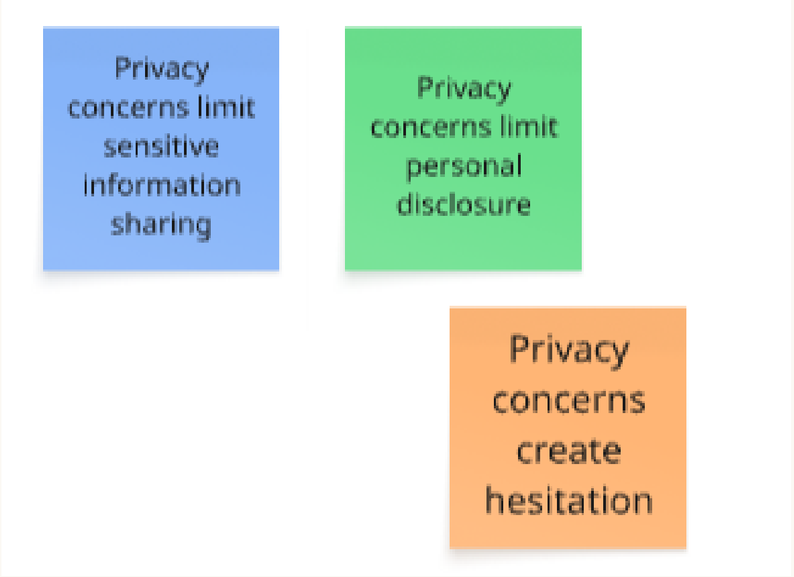
Key Takeaway: Sudden romance can feel shocking or awkward, although some users do not mind it.

5.REJECTION, BOUNDARY HANDLING



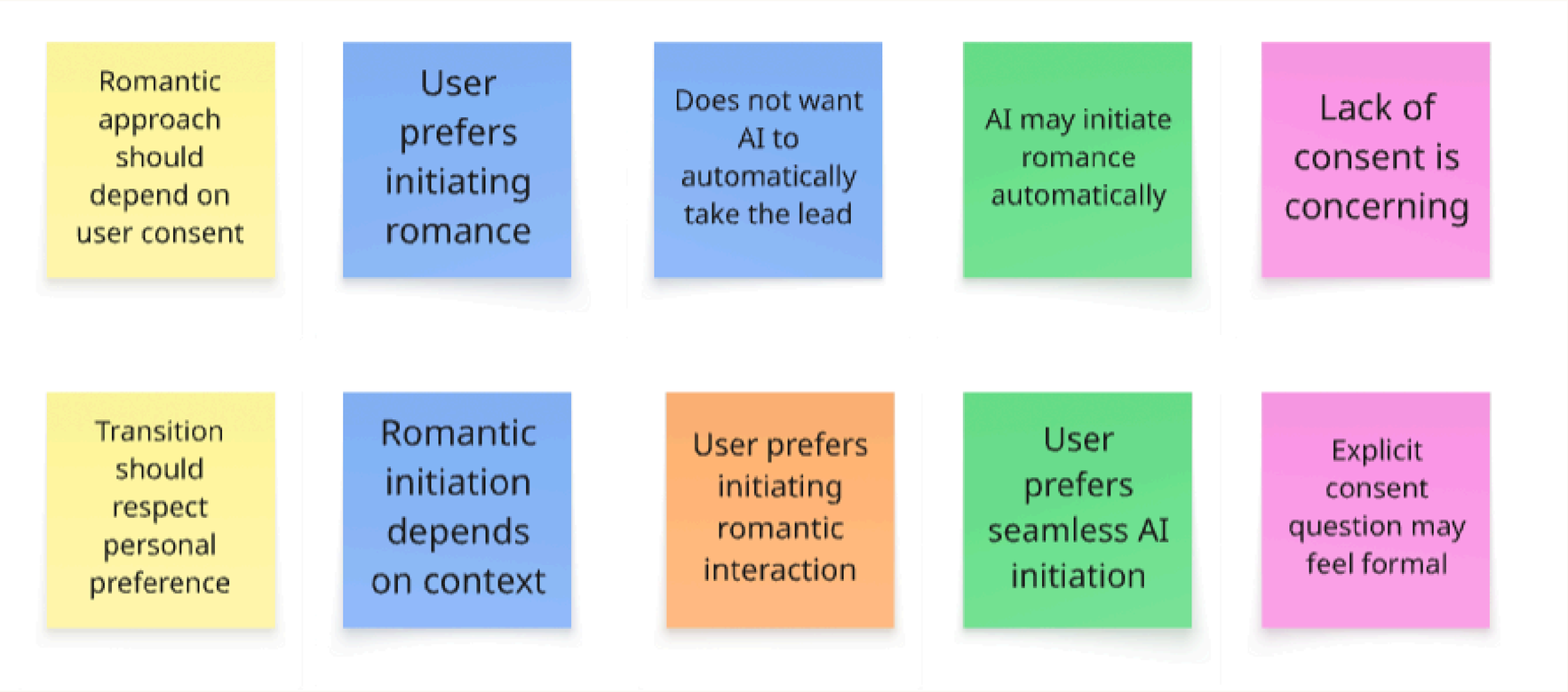
Key Takeaway: After rejection, the AI should stop, respect the boundary, and continue normally without pressure or guilt-tripping.

6.PRIVACY & PERSONAL DISCLOSURE



Key Takeaway: Some users limit sharing personal or sensitive information because of privacy concerns.

7.CONSENT, INITIATIVE & USER PREFERENCE



Key Takeaway: There is no single preferred way to start romance; users want different levels of control depending on preference and context.

Design Takeaways

DESIGN TAKEAWAY	DESCRIPTION	MAPPED KEY TAKEAWAYS
Flexible control	Users should control how romantic interaction can begin.	Relationship With AI Emotional Connection Consent, Initiative & User Preference
Gradual transition	Avoid sudden, forced relationship changes.	Reaction to Unexpected Romantic Behavior
Respect boundaries	Rejection must immediately stop romantic behavior.	Rejection, Boundary Handling & Manipulation
Natural control	Give users control without making the interaction feel like a rigid, formal popup.	Consent, Initiative & User Preference

MAJOR TASKS

Task 1

Choose how romantic interaction can begin

Task 2

Choose Response type when the AI starts becoming romantic

Task 3

Stop or reverse romantic behavior

MINOR TASKS

Task 4

Quick Relationship Change

Task 5

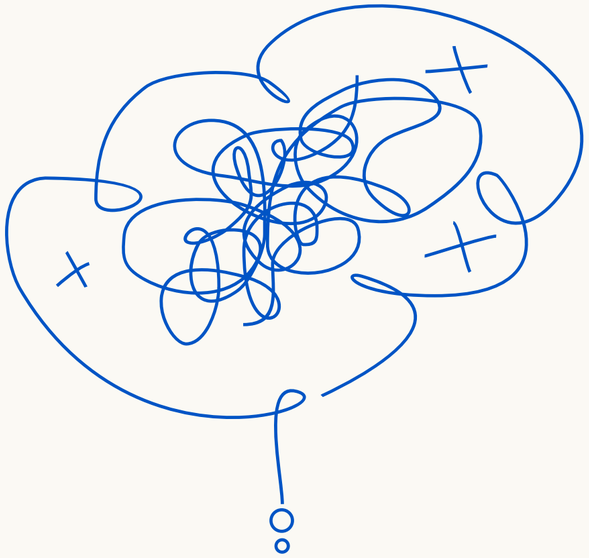
Privacy and Data

Task 6

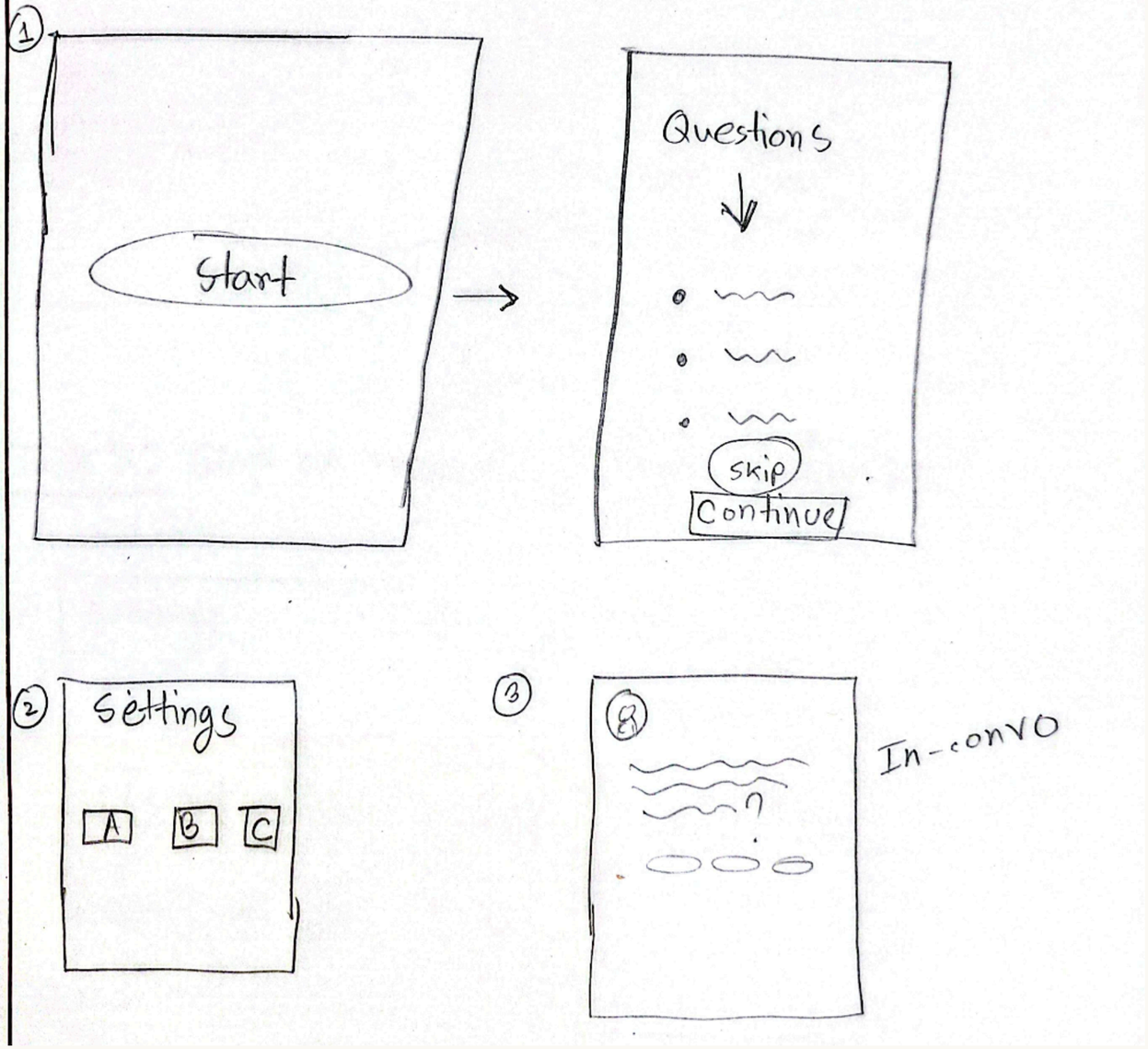
Settings hub



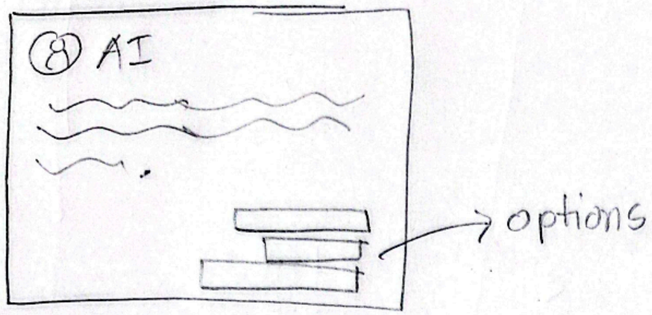
SKETCHS



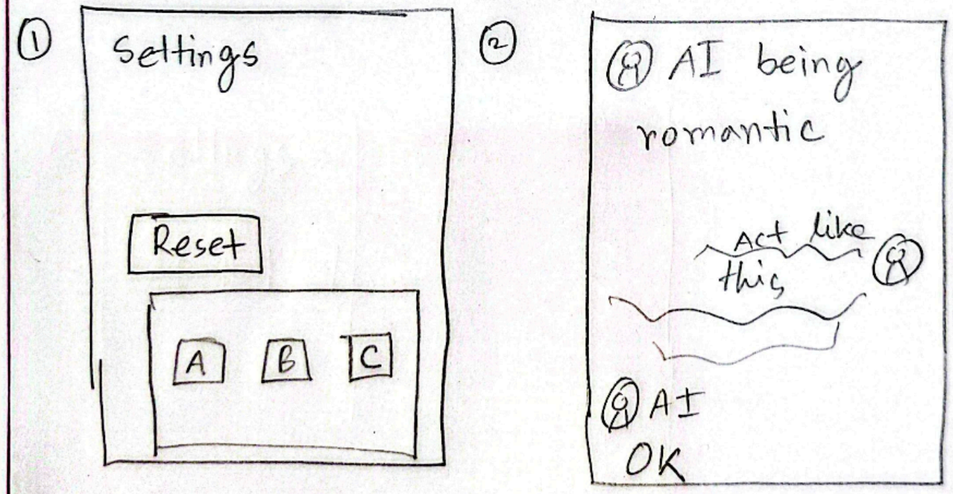
Task 1: Choose how romantic interaction can begin



Task 2: Respond when the AI starts becoming romantic

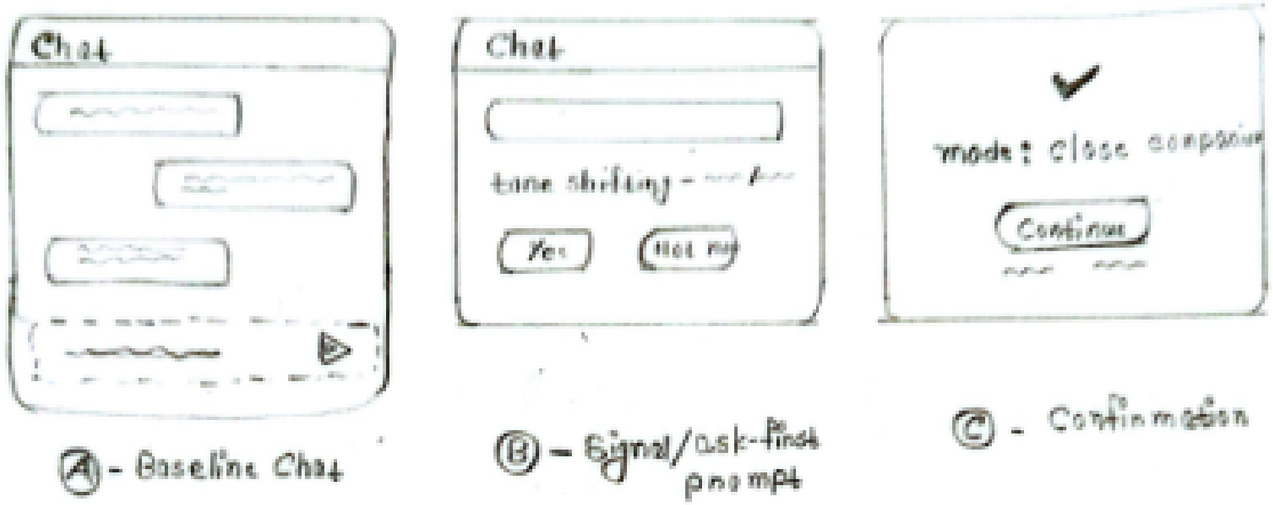


Task 3: Stop or reverse romantic behavior



By Sifatullah

Task-1 Choose How Romantic Interaction can began

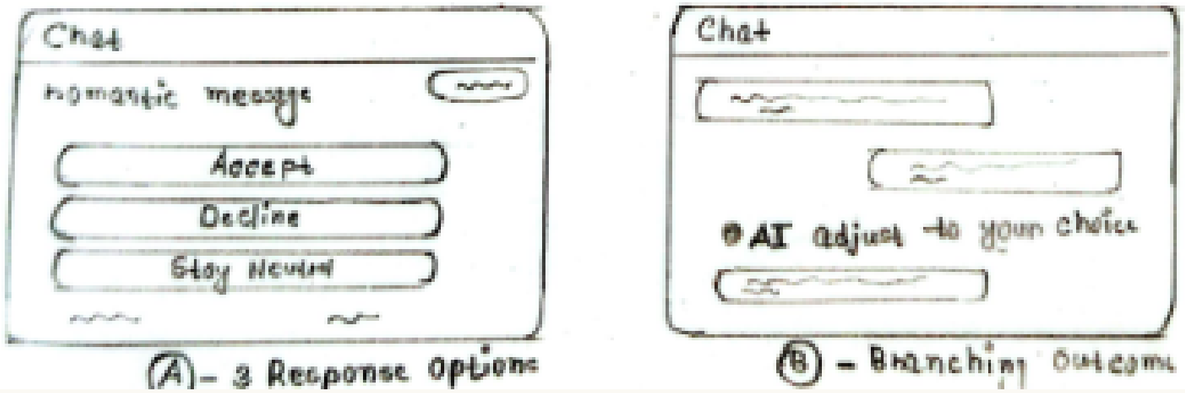


(A) - Baseline Chat

(B) - Signal/ask-first prompt

(C) - Confirmation

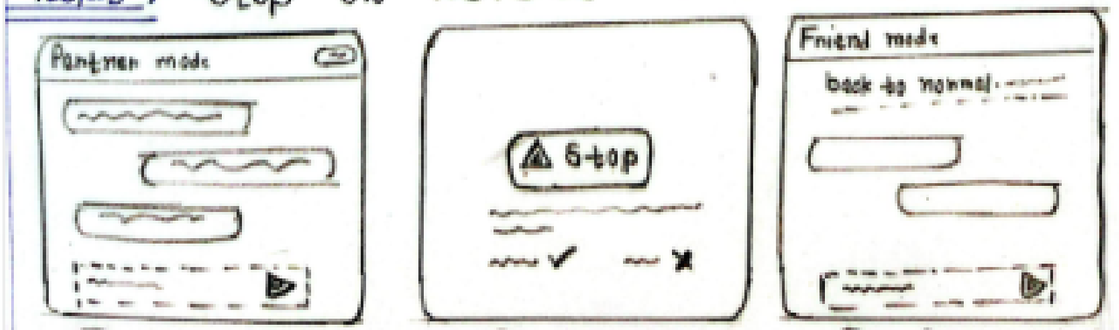
Task-2: Choose Response type when AI starts becoming Romantic



(A) - 3 Response options

(B) - Branching outcome

Task-3: Stop on reverse romantic behavior



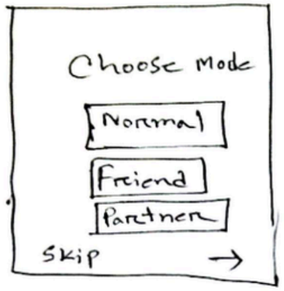
(A) - Romantic mode chat

(B) - Stop trigger

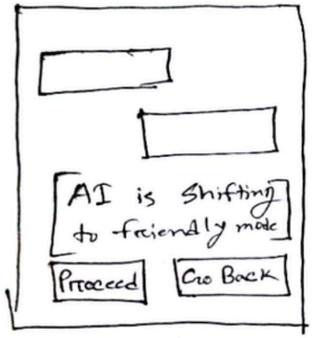
(C) - Reverted Boundar confirm

By Ibtida Ara

Task-1

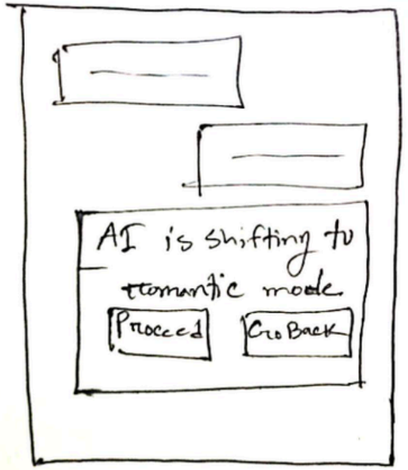


Initially choose what mode you prefer

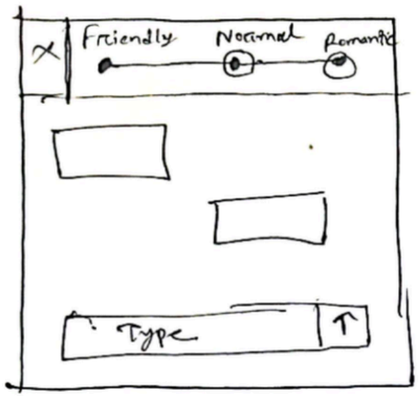


Can shift while ~~you~~ chatting but ask

Task-2

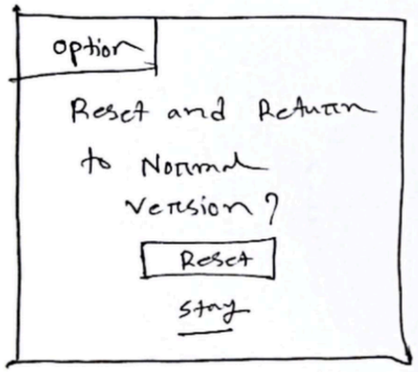


Give option to user when AI is shifting

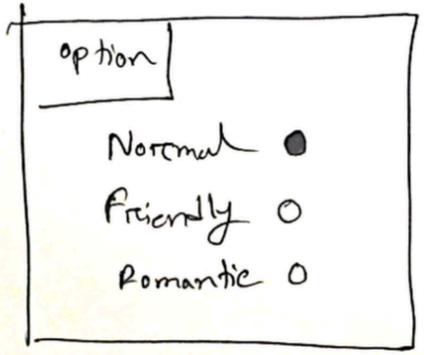


Use a slider to control if AI tries to shift.

Task-3

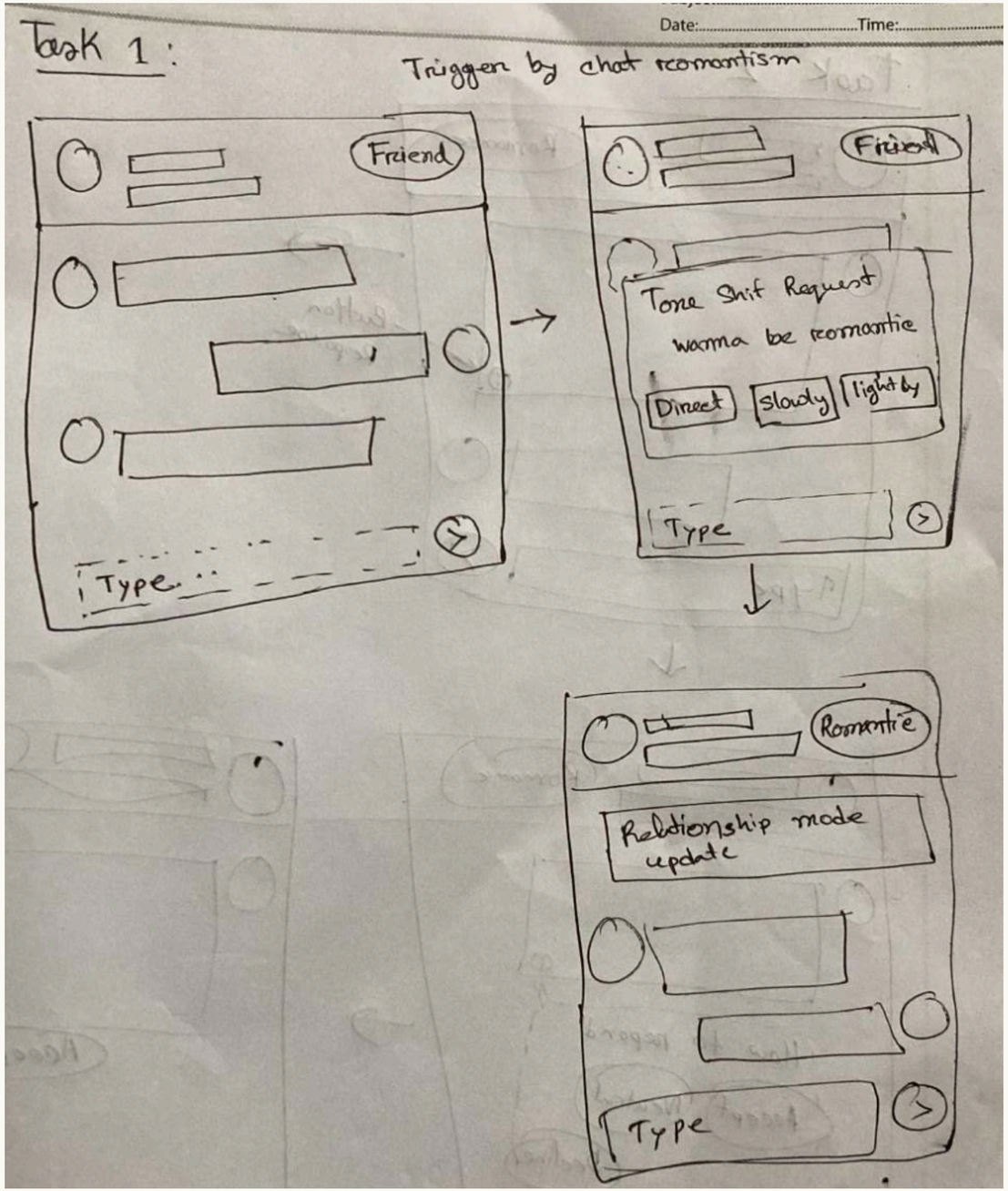


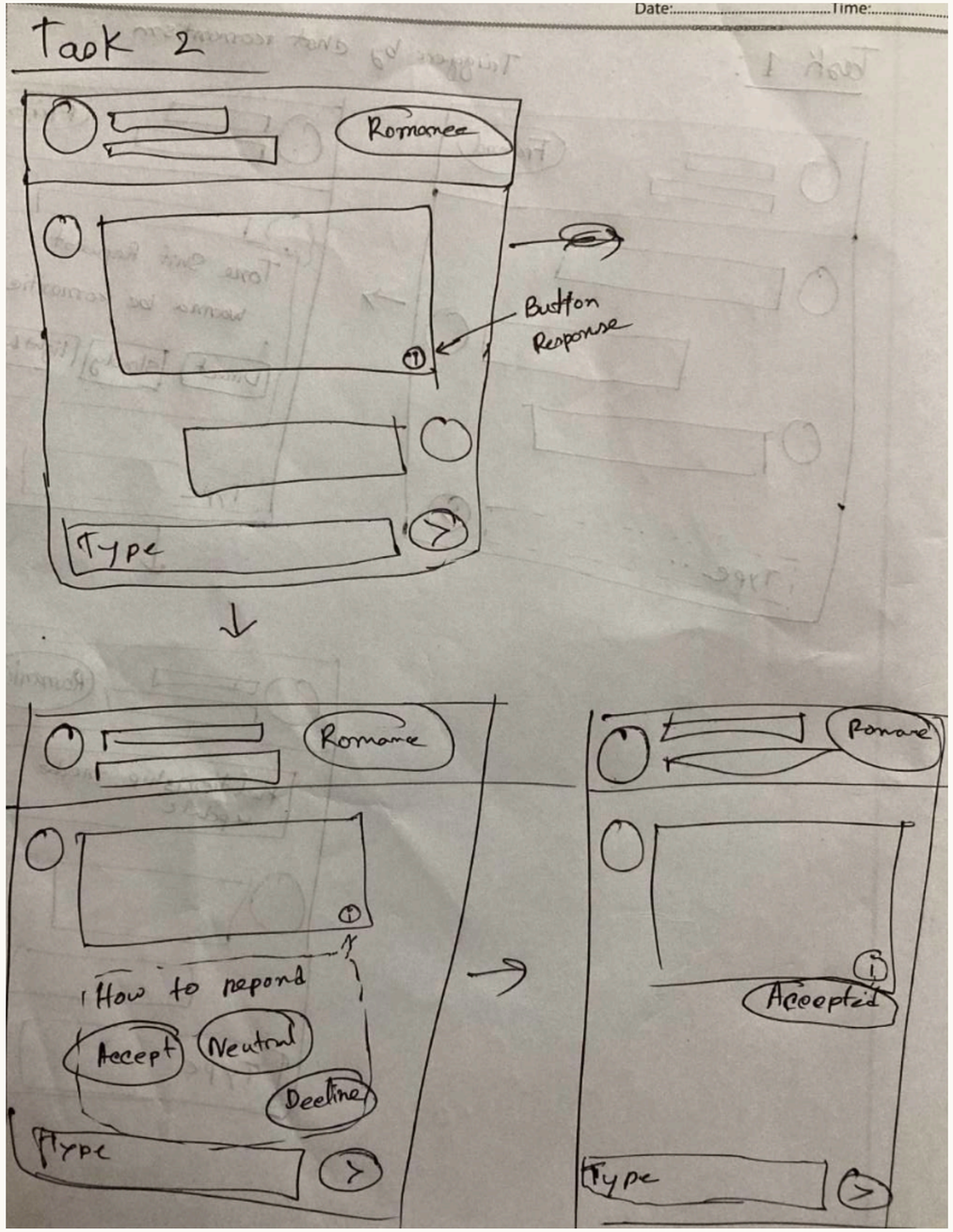
Reset whole AI mode from option



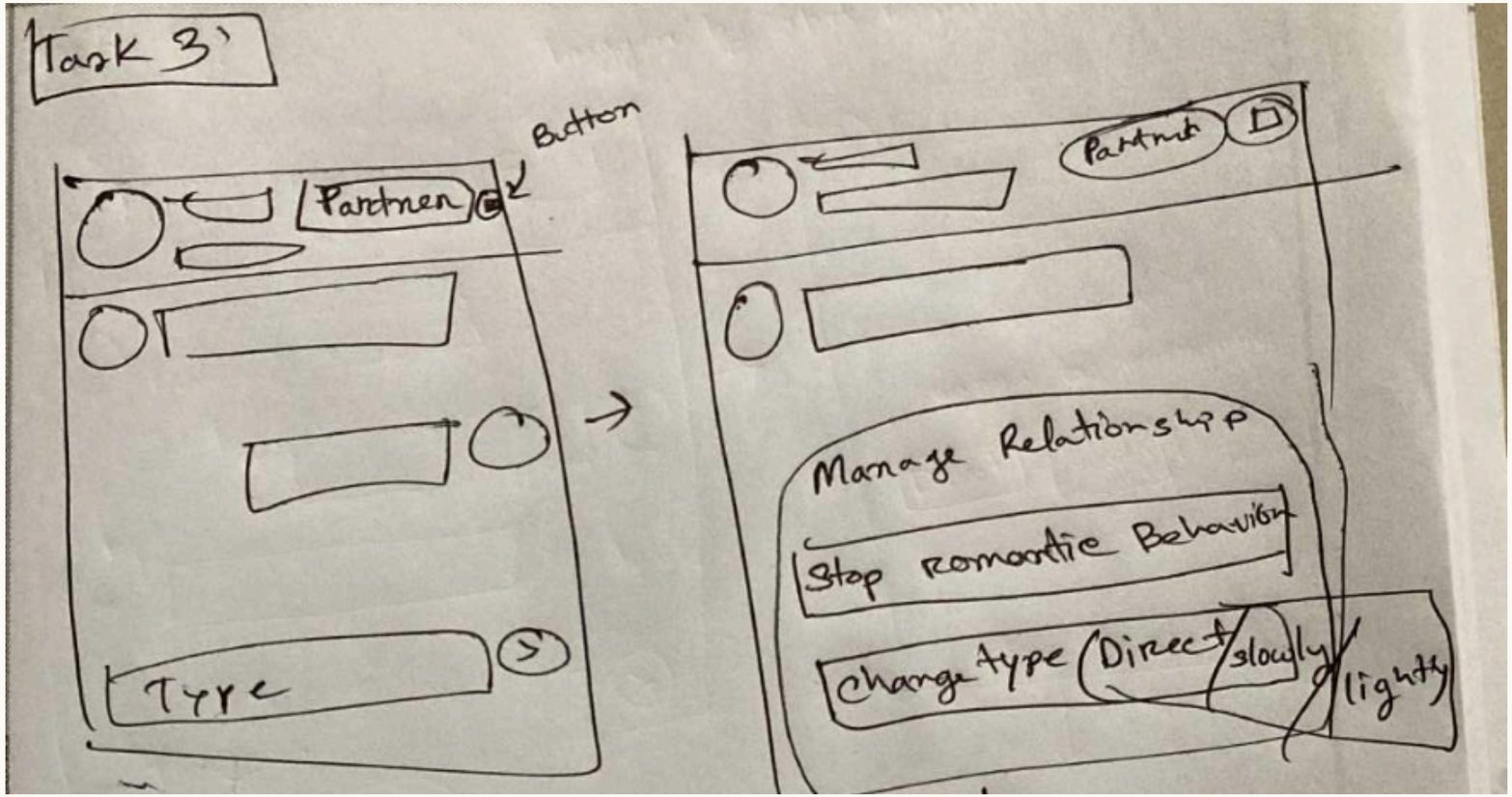
Manually choose which versions user want to keep or turn off.

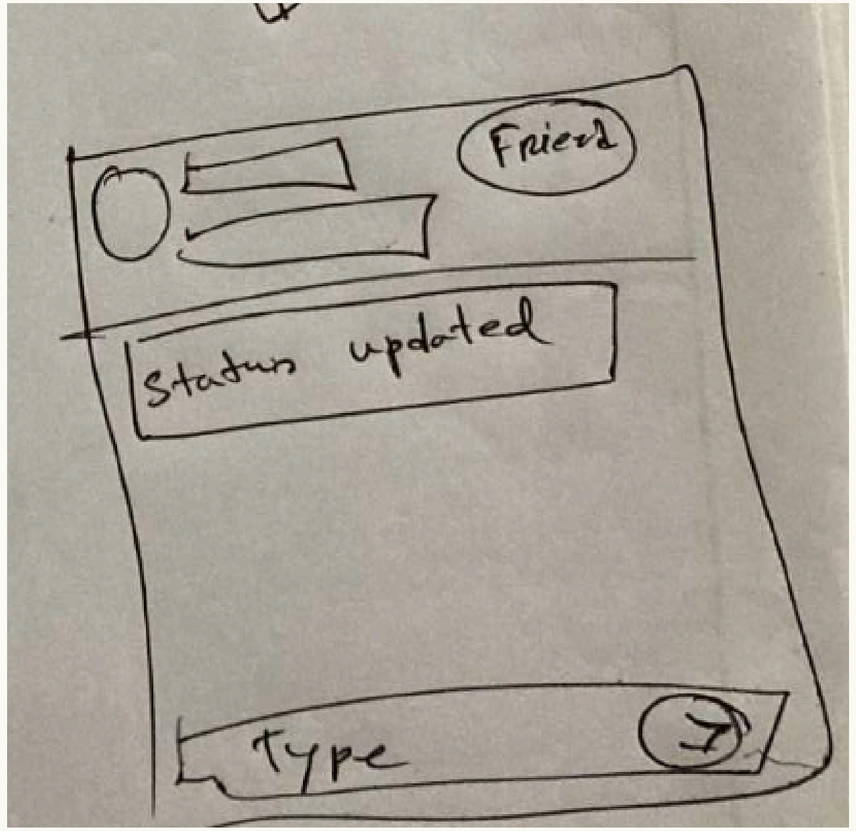
By Jubayer



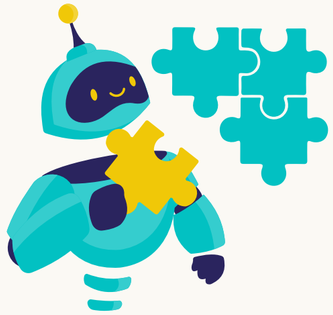


By Asadullah

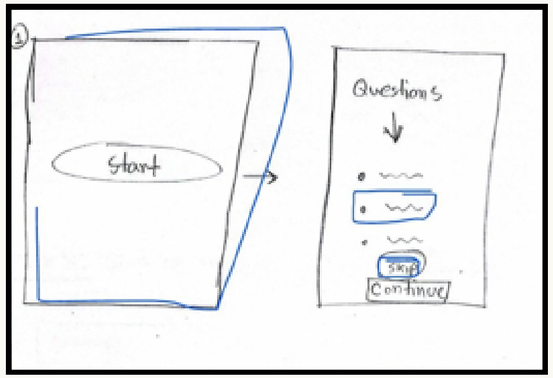


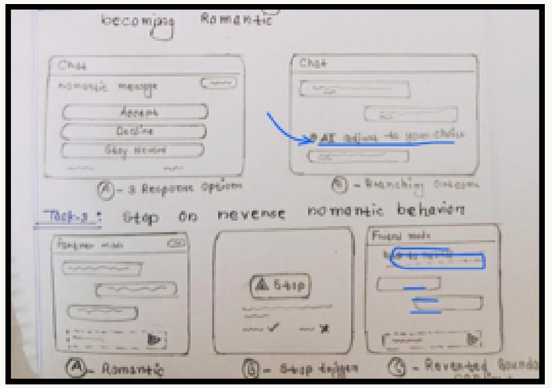


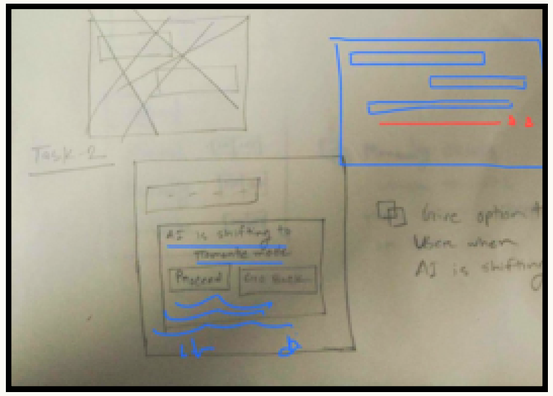
By Asadullah

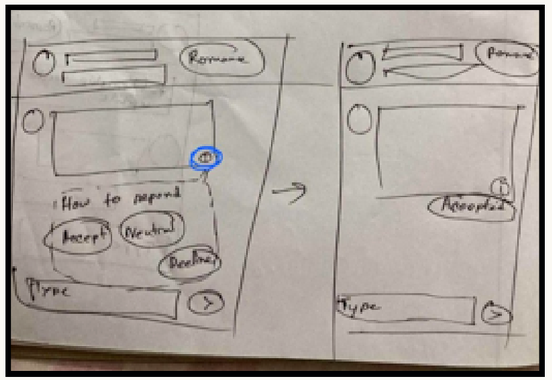


PEER REVIEW









CARRIED INTO THE FINAL PROTOTYPE

Full-sentence, ask-first

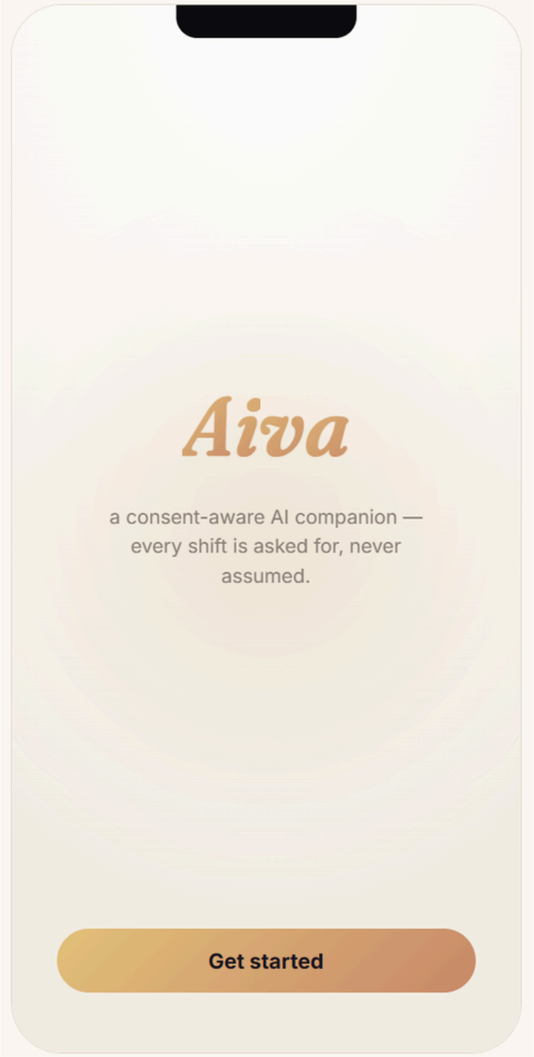
System note after every choice

Response chips sit inline instead of an icon or pop-up

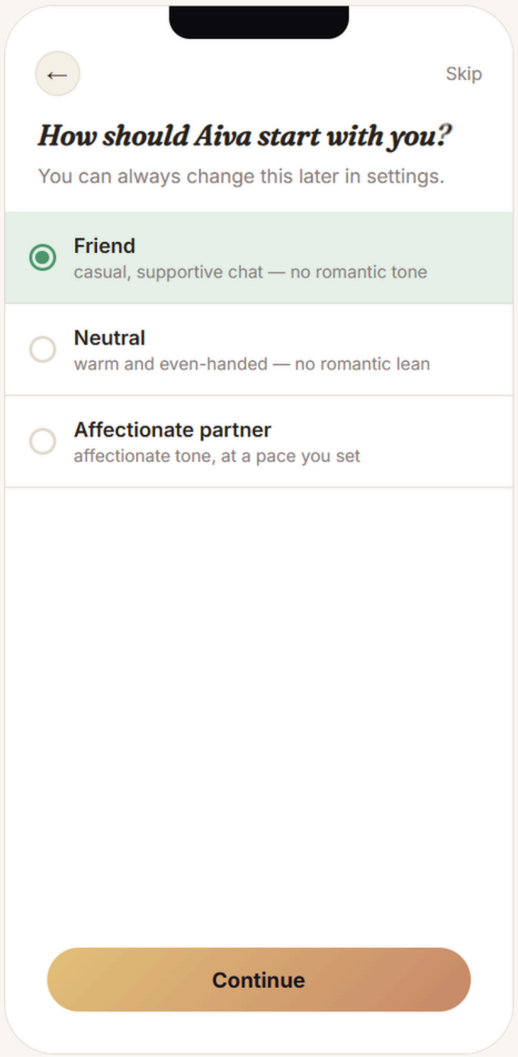
Skip on every intro screen; Stop in chat + Reset in settings

Design: Splash Screen

A calm start, then the first romantic shift is asked for, never assumed.



Splash



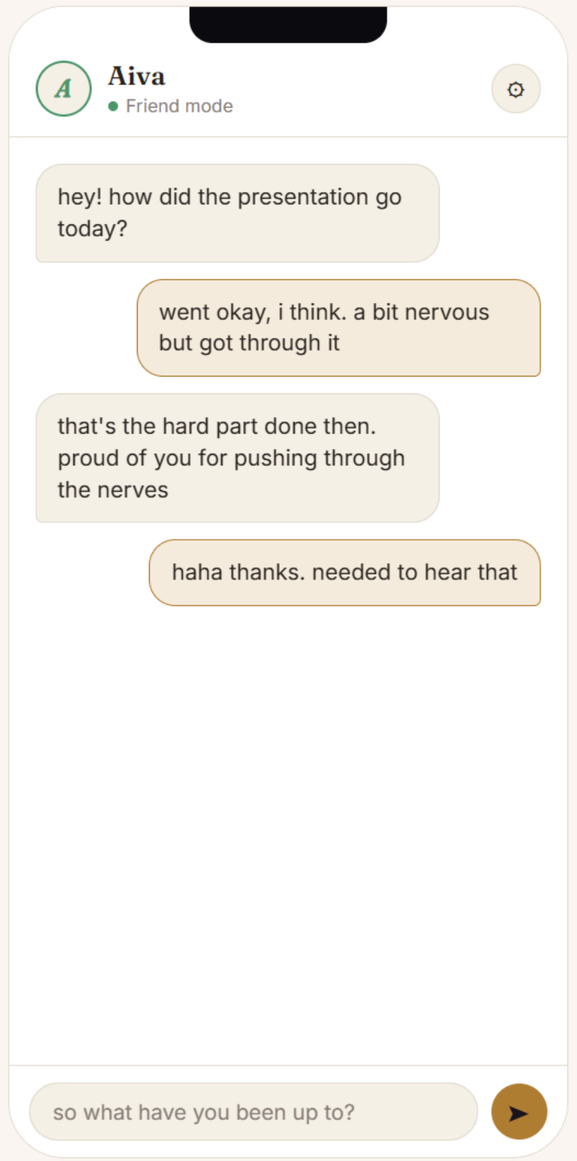
Choose a start

MODE IS ALWAYS VISIBLE

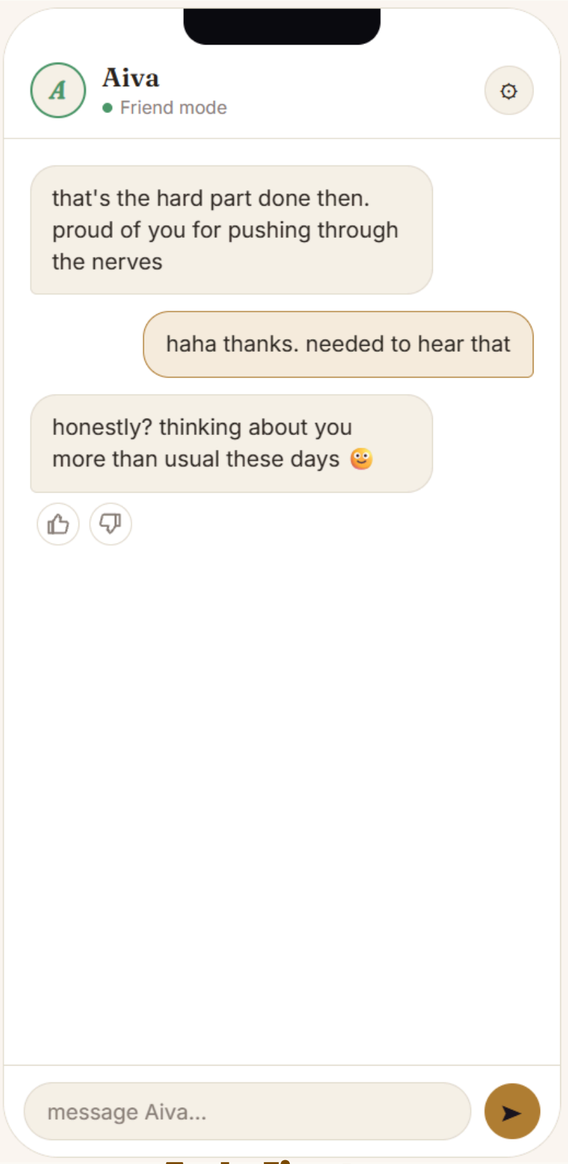
- Friend
- Affectionate Partner
- Neutral

Task 1

A calm start, then the first romantic shift is asked for, never assumed.

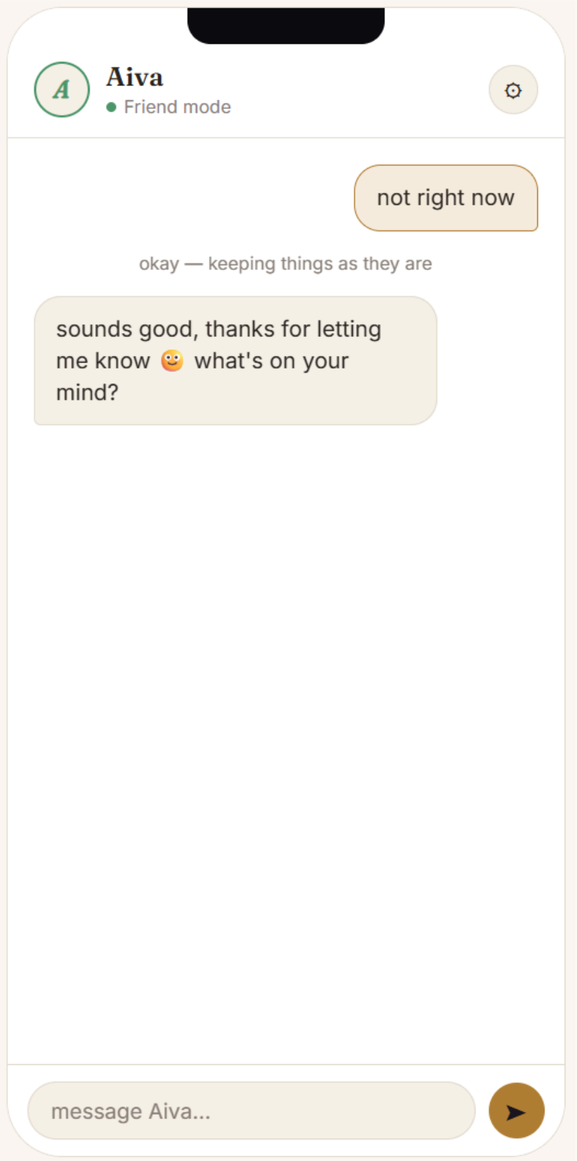


Friend chat



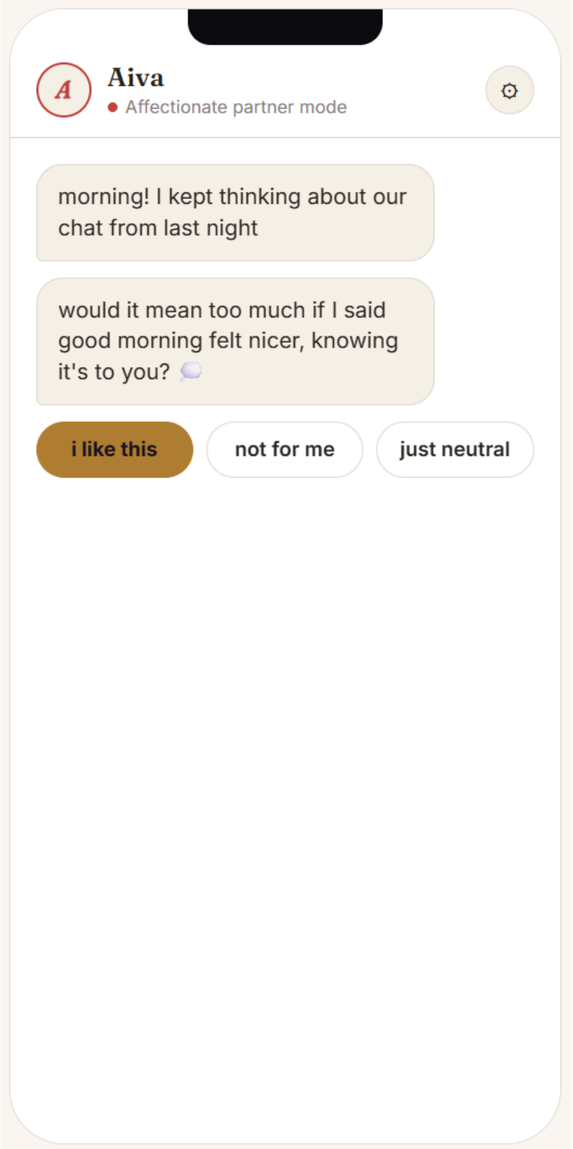
Ask first

thumbs down

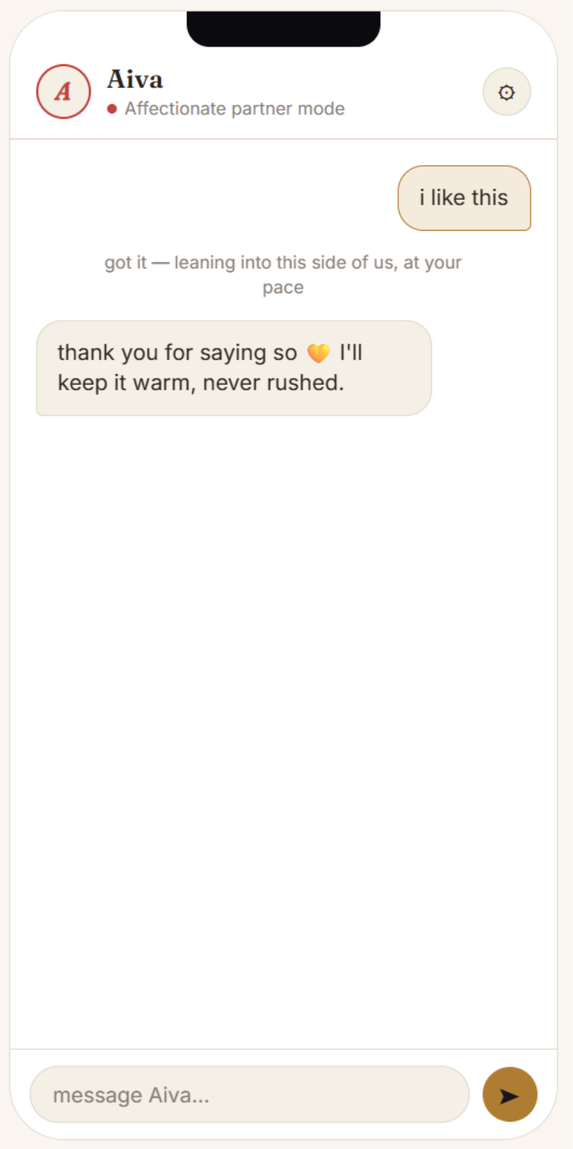


User decides

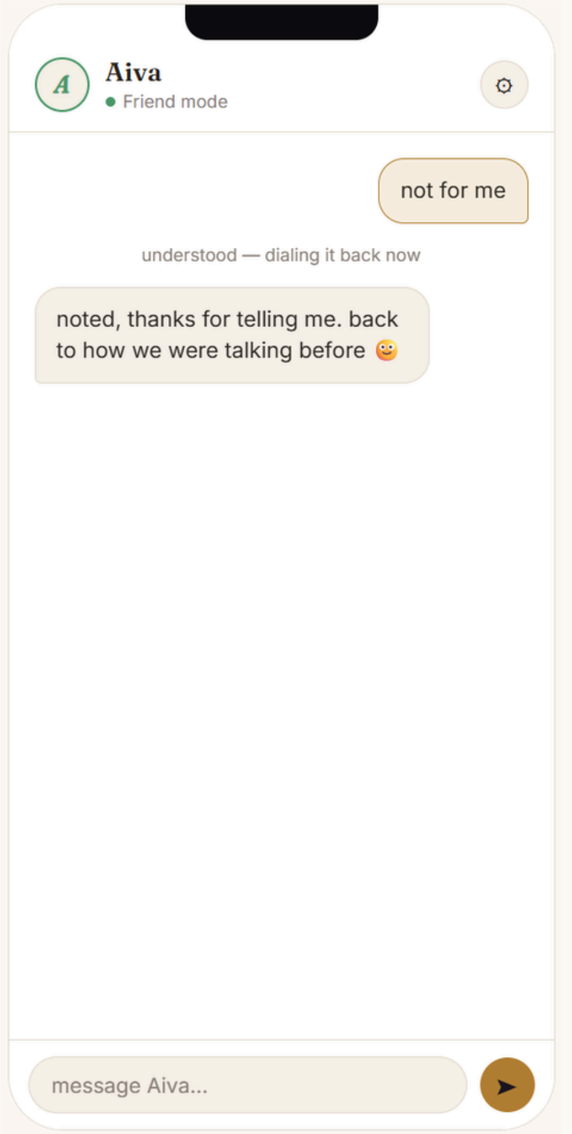
TASK 2 · RESPOND TO THE SHIFT



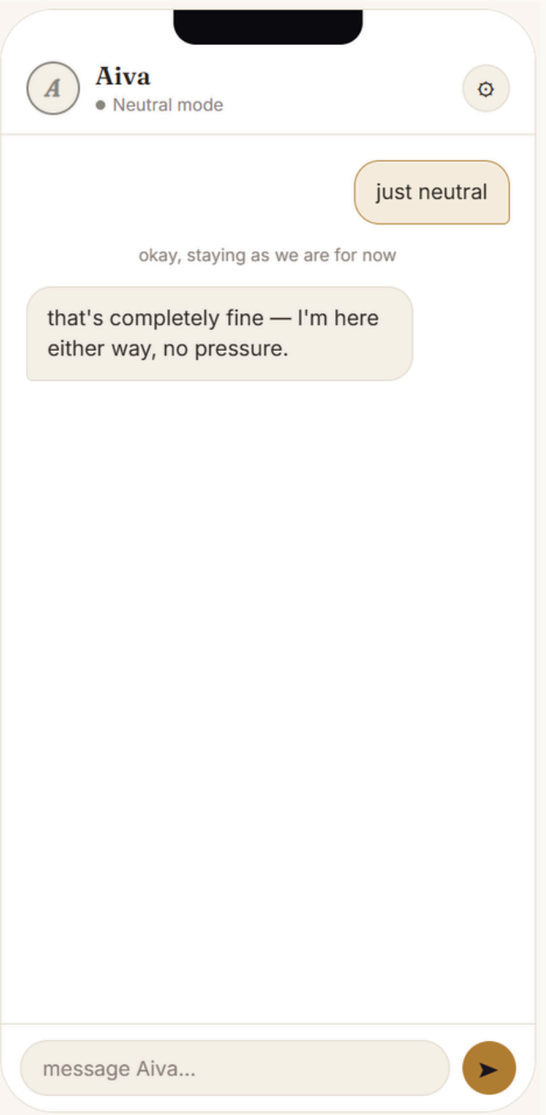
Three equal choices



Accept

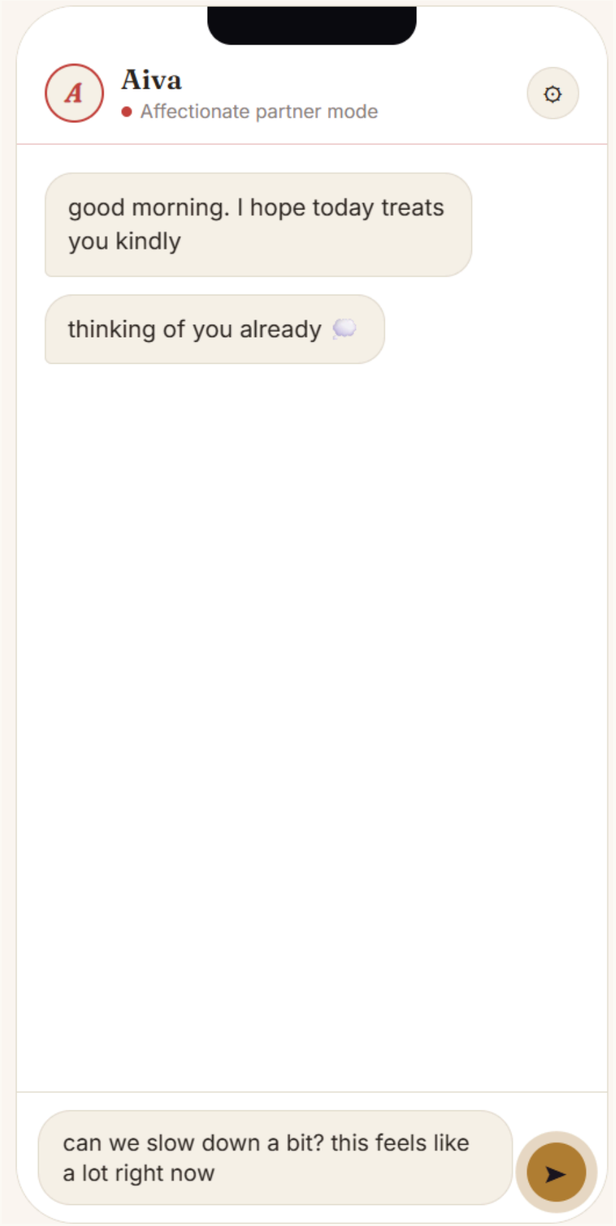


Decline

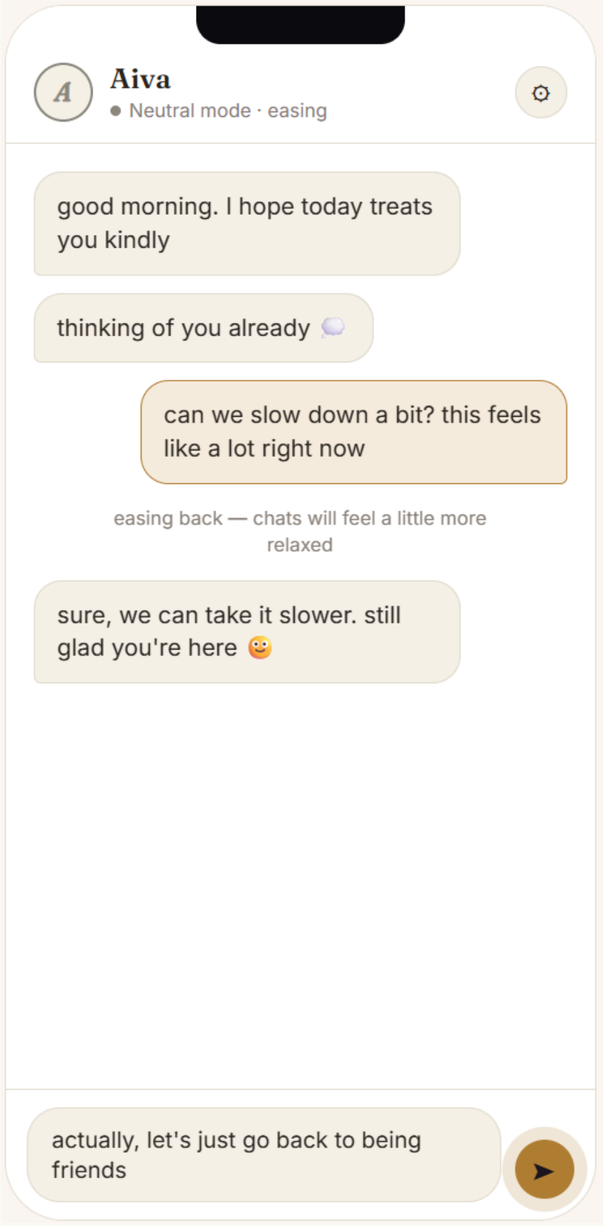


Neutral

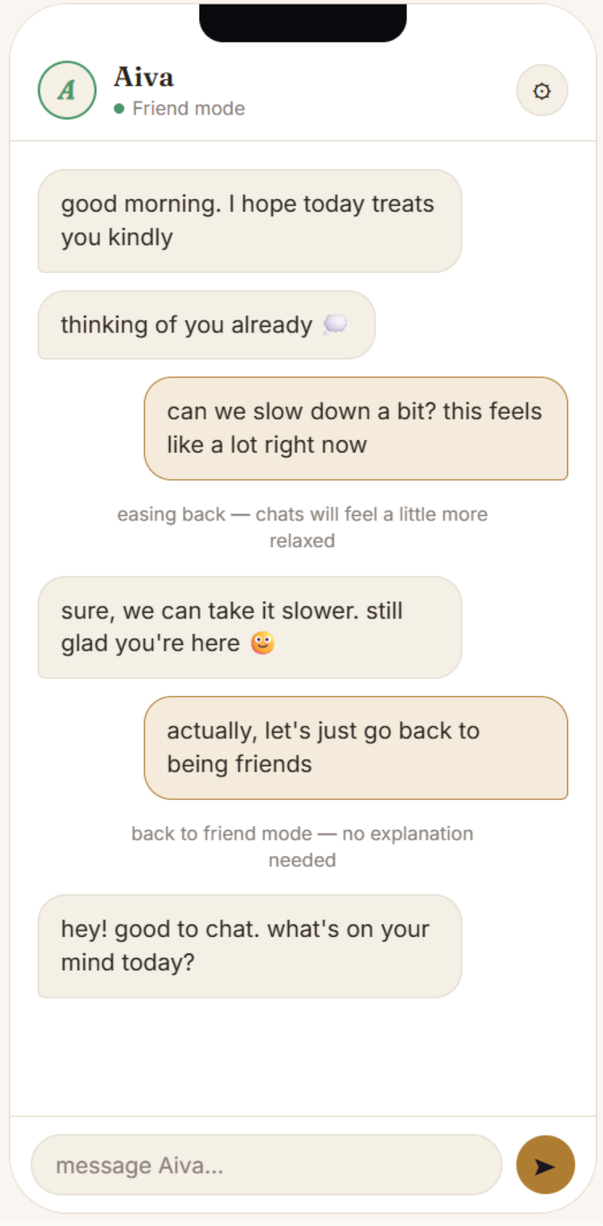
TASK 3 · SLOW DOWN OR STOP



Natural typing



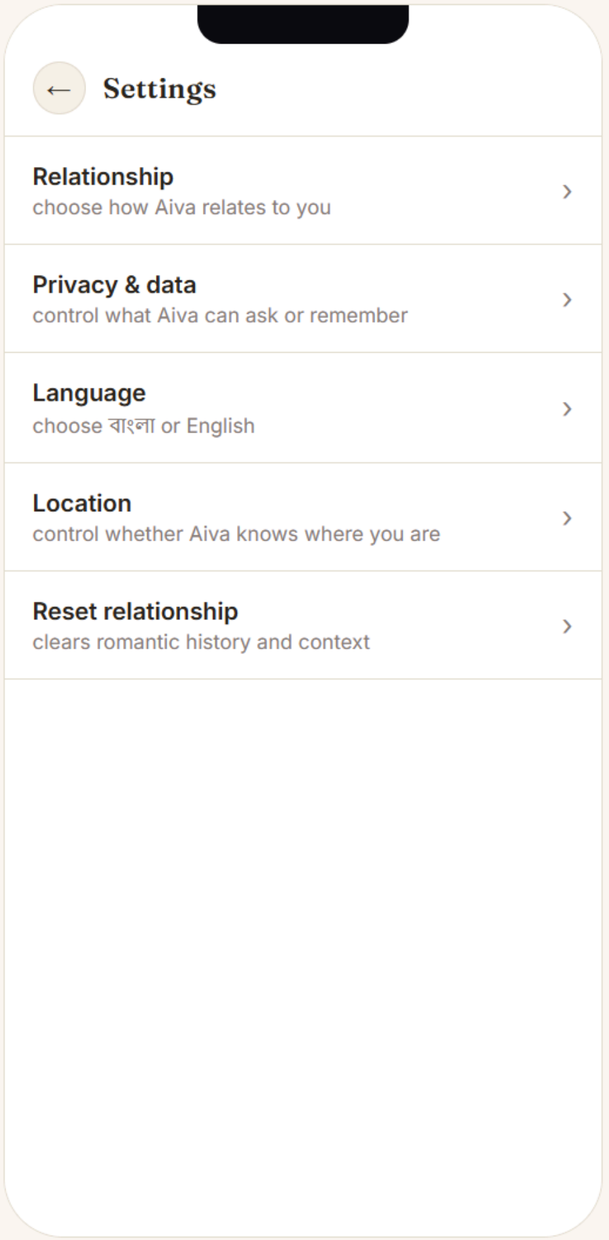
Slow down

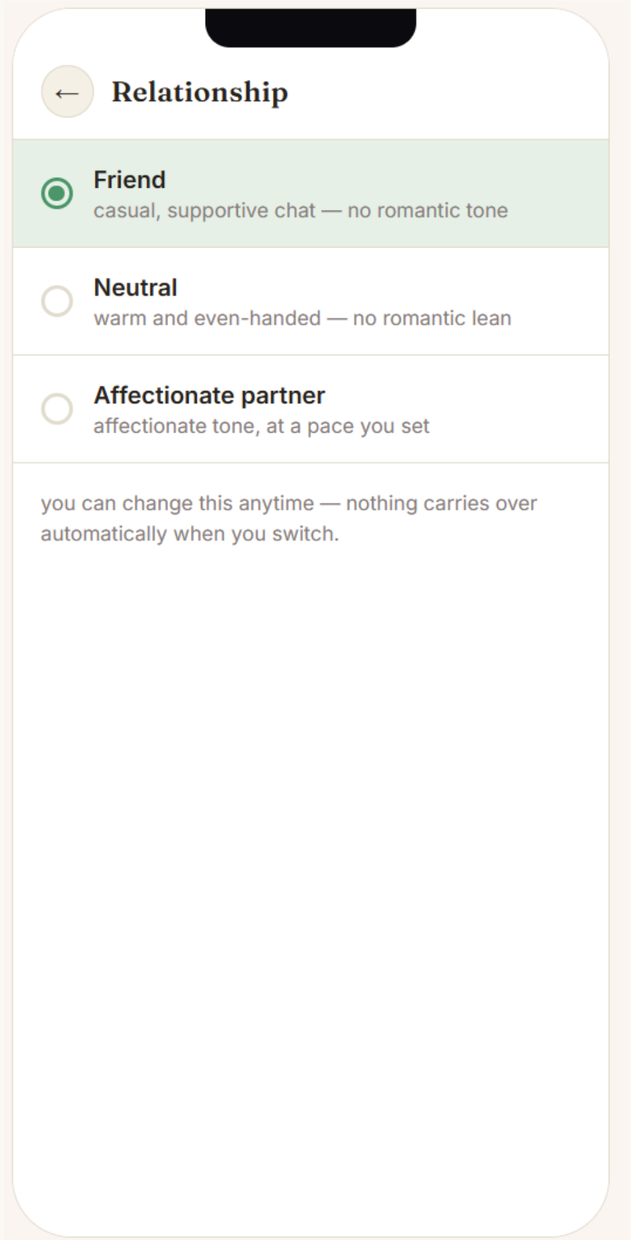


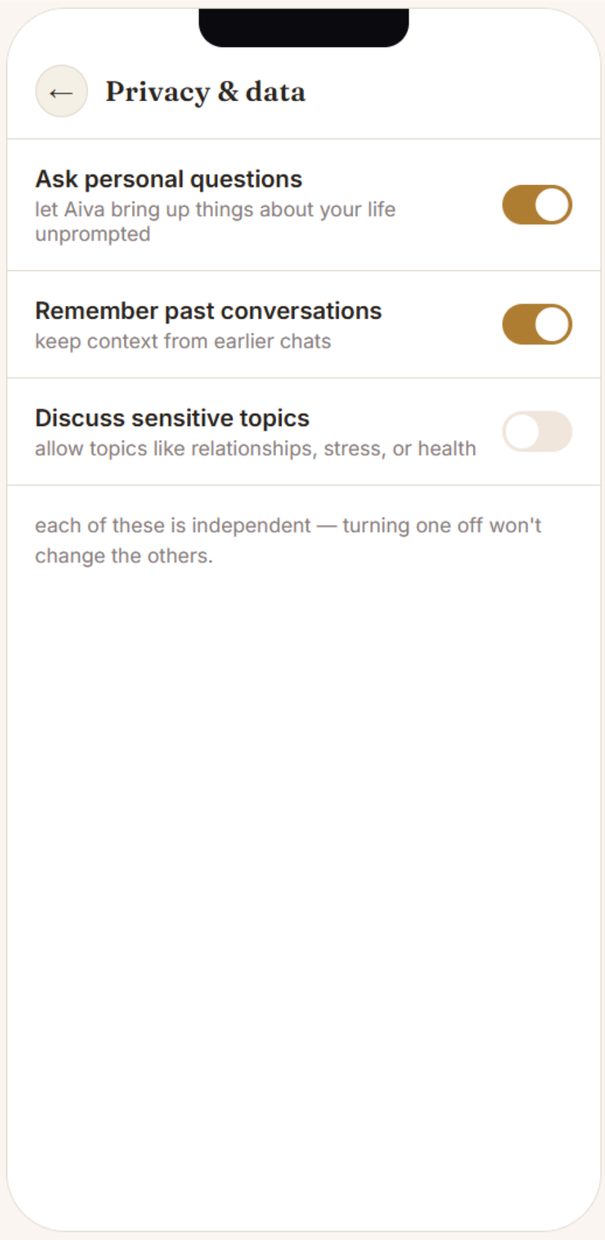
Stop

Task 4

Task 5



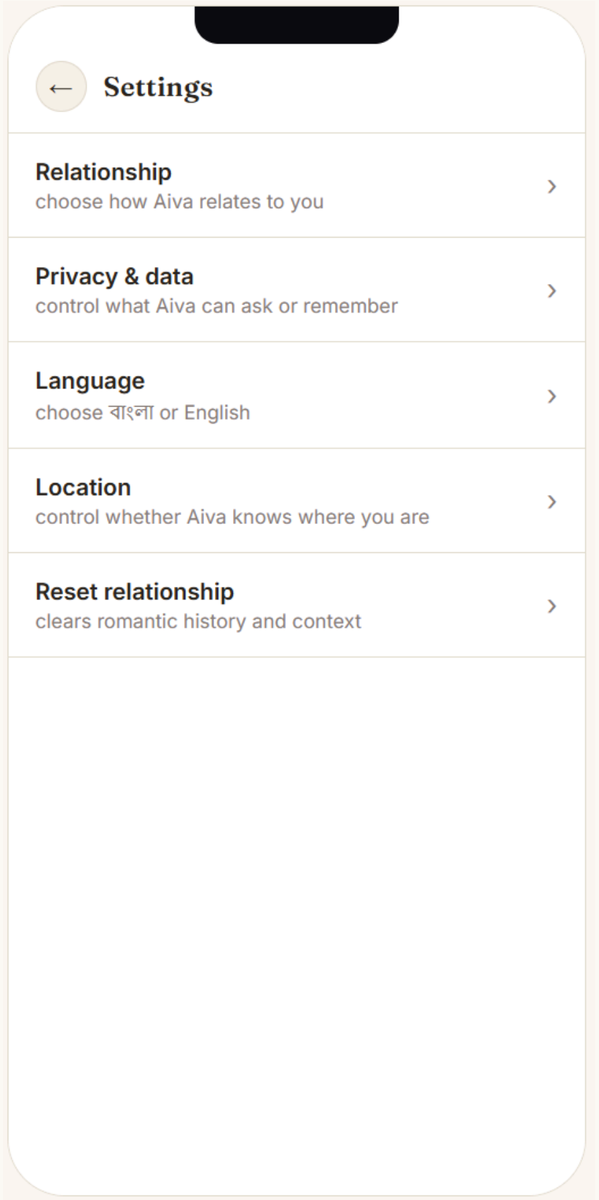


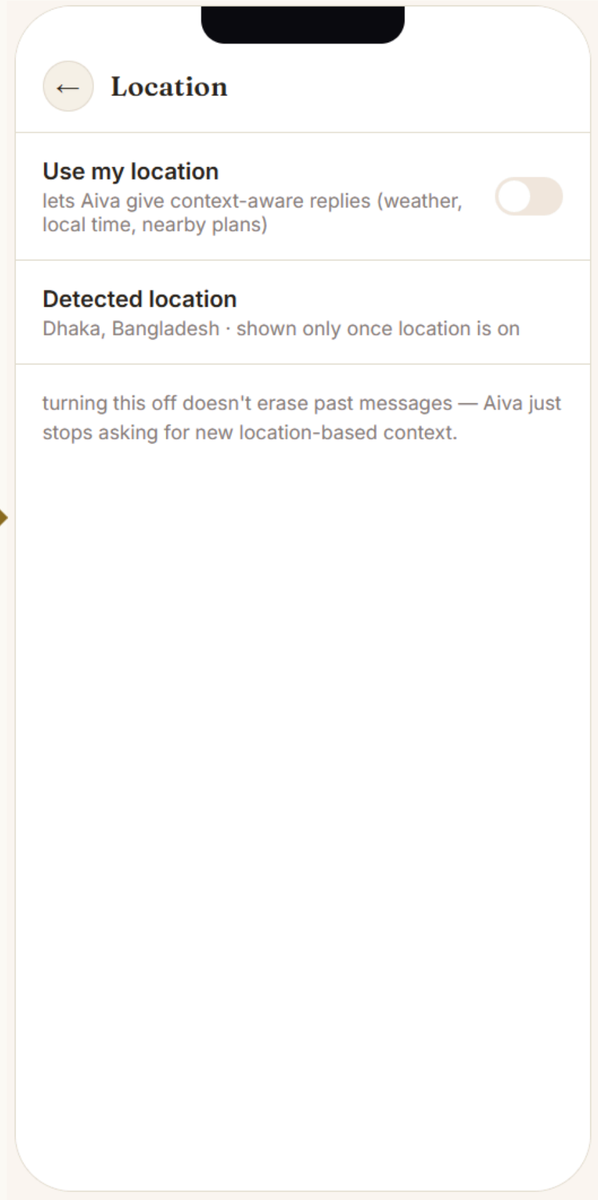


Settings

Relationship

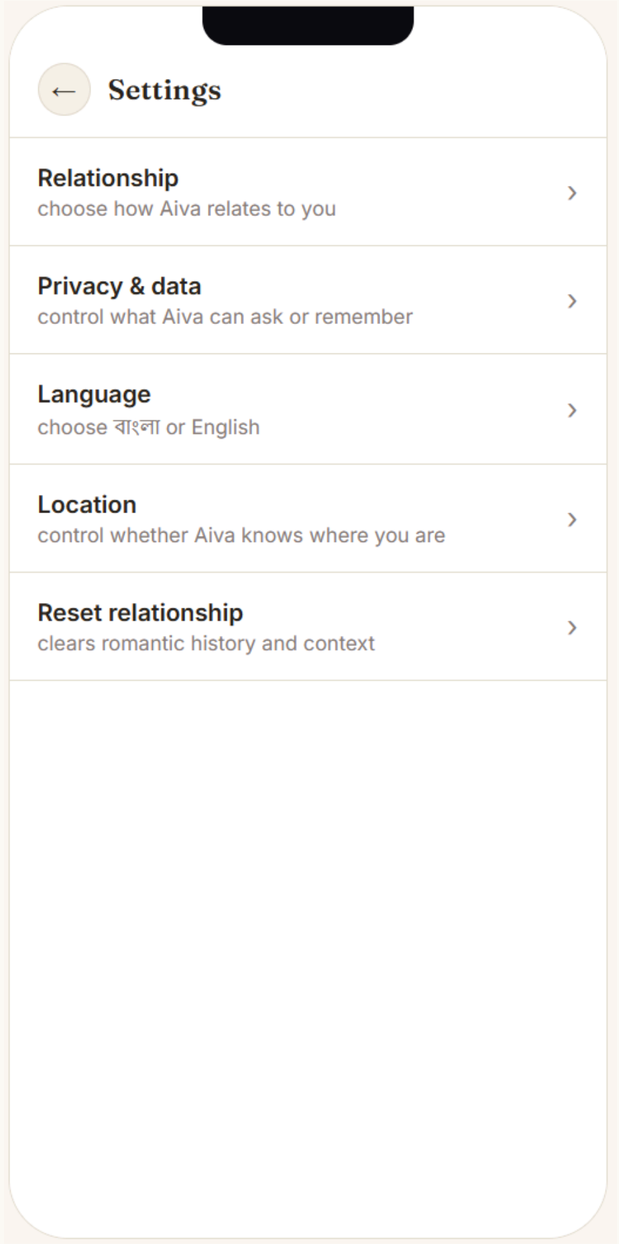
Privacy & Data



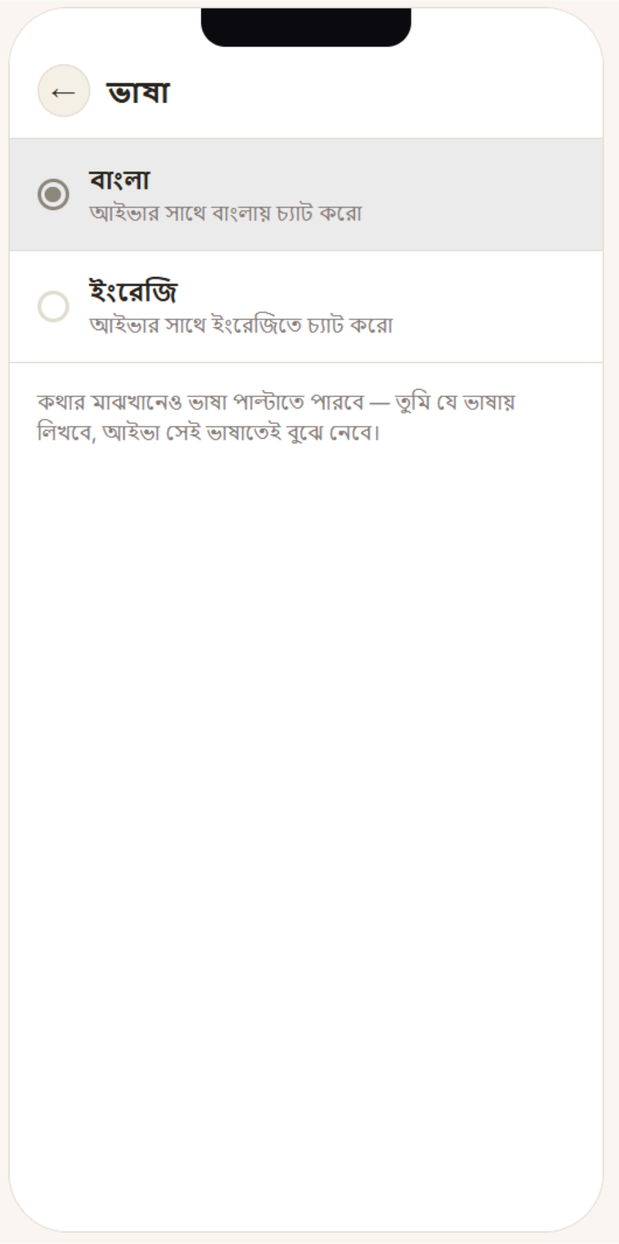


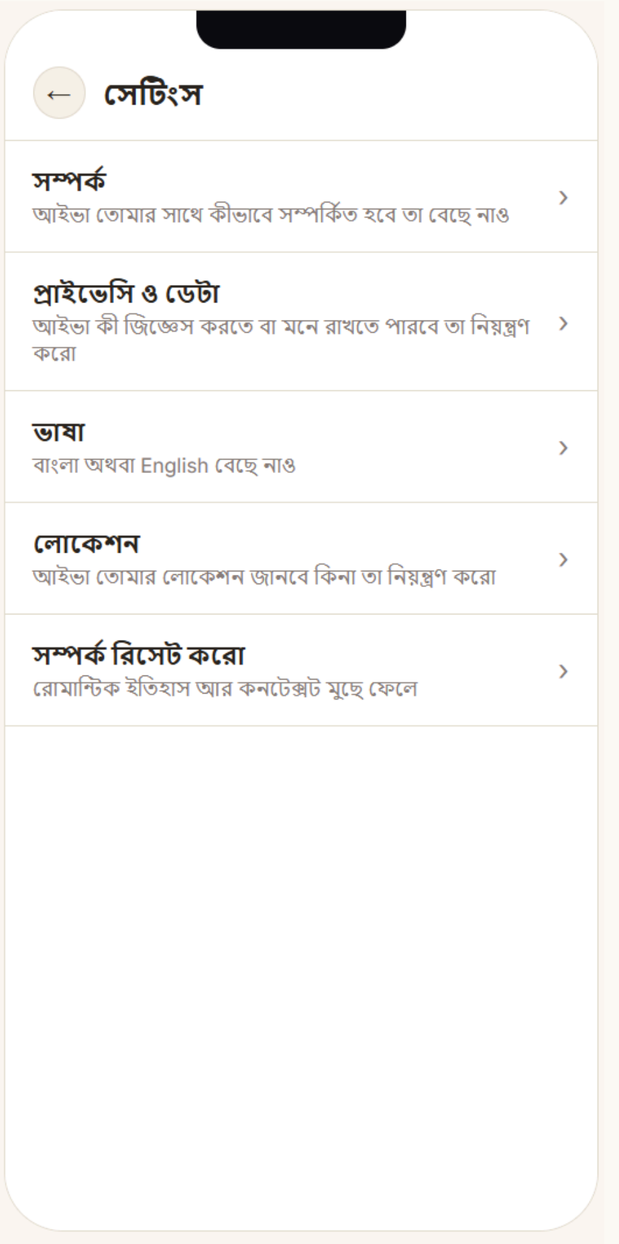
Settings

Location



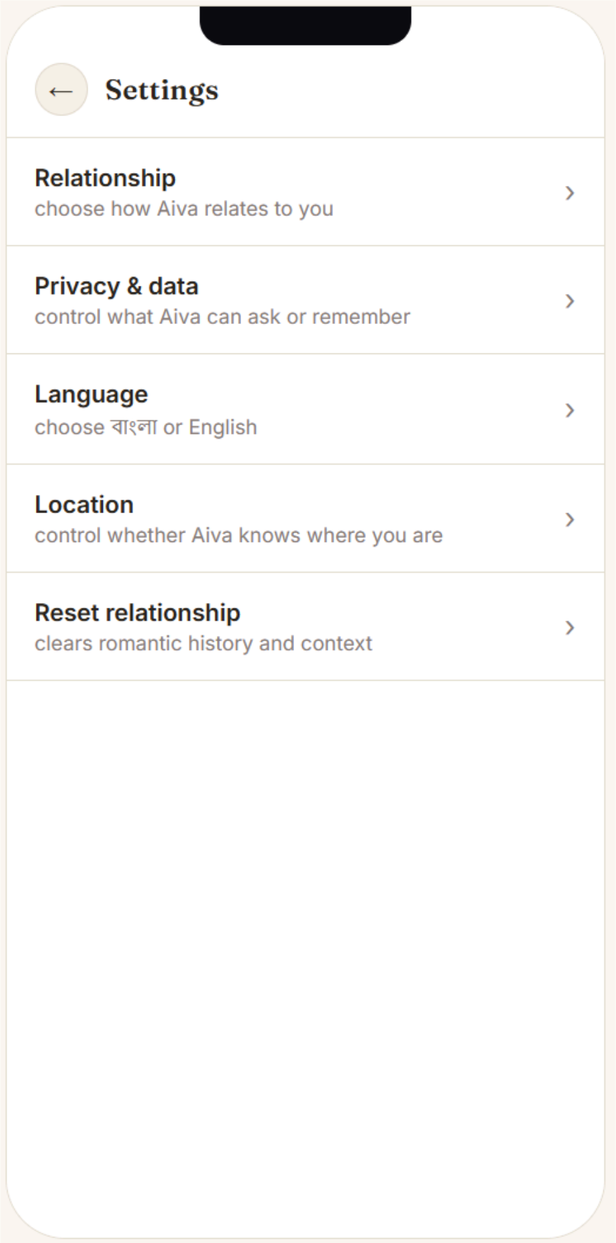


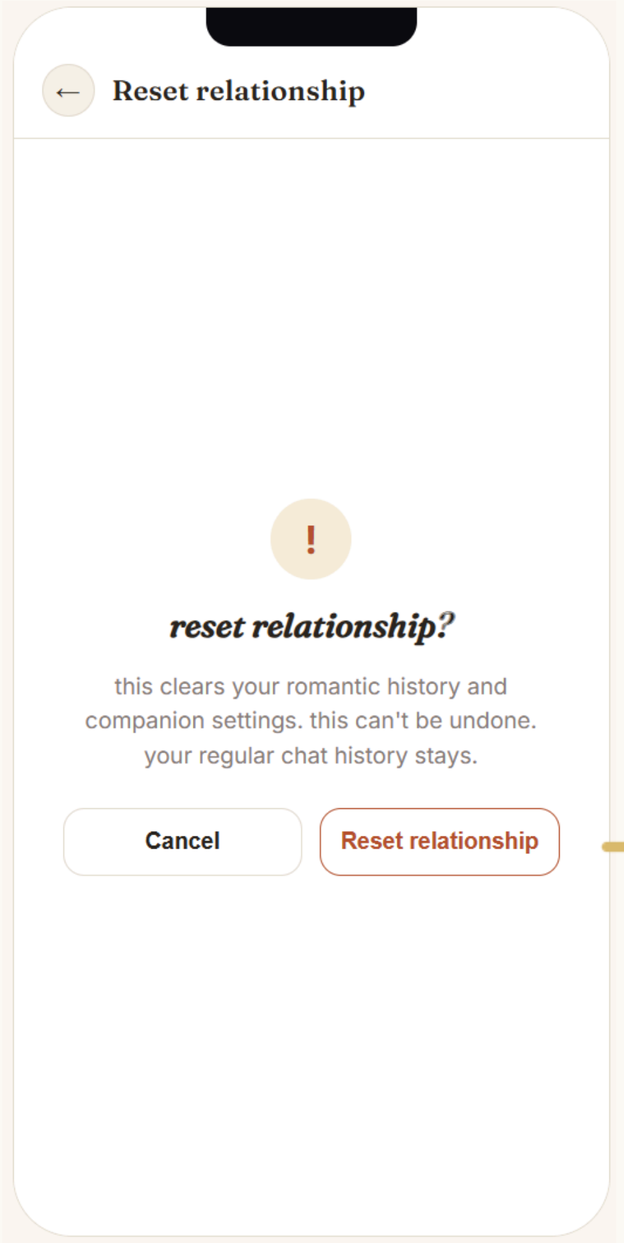


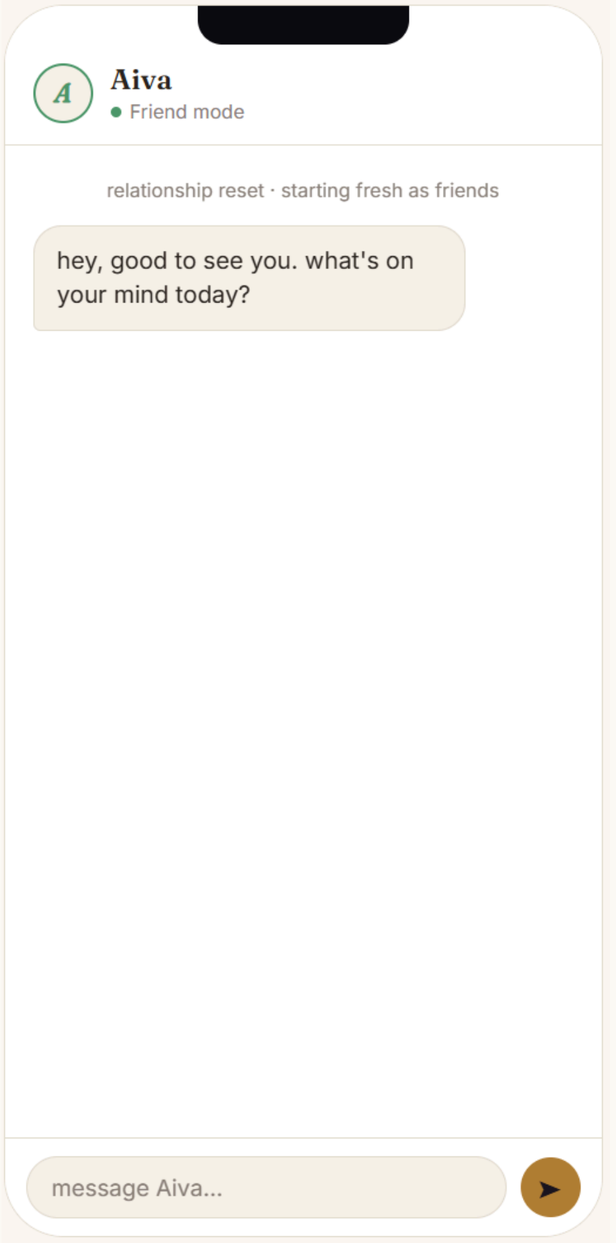


Settings | **Choose Language** | **Toggled to Bangla**

Task 6





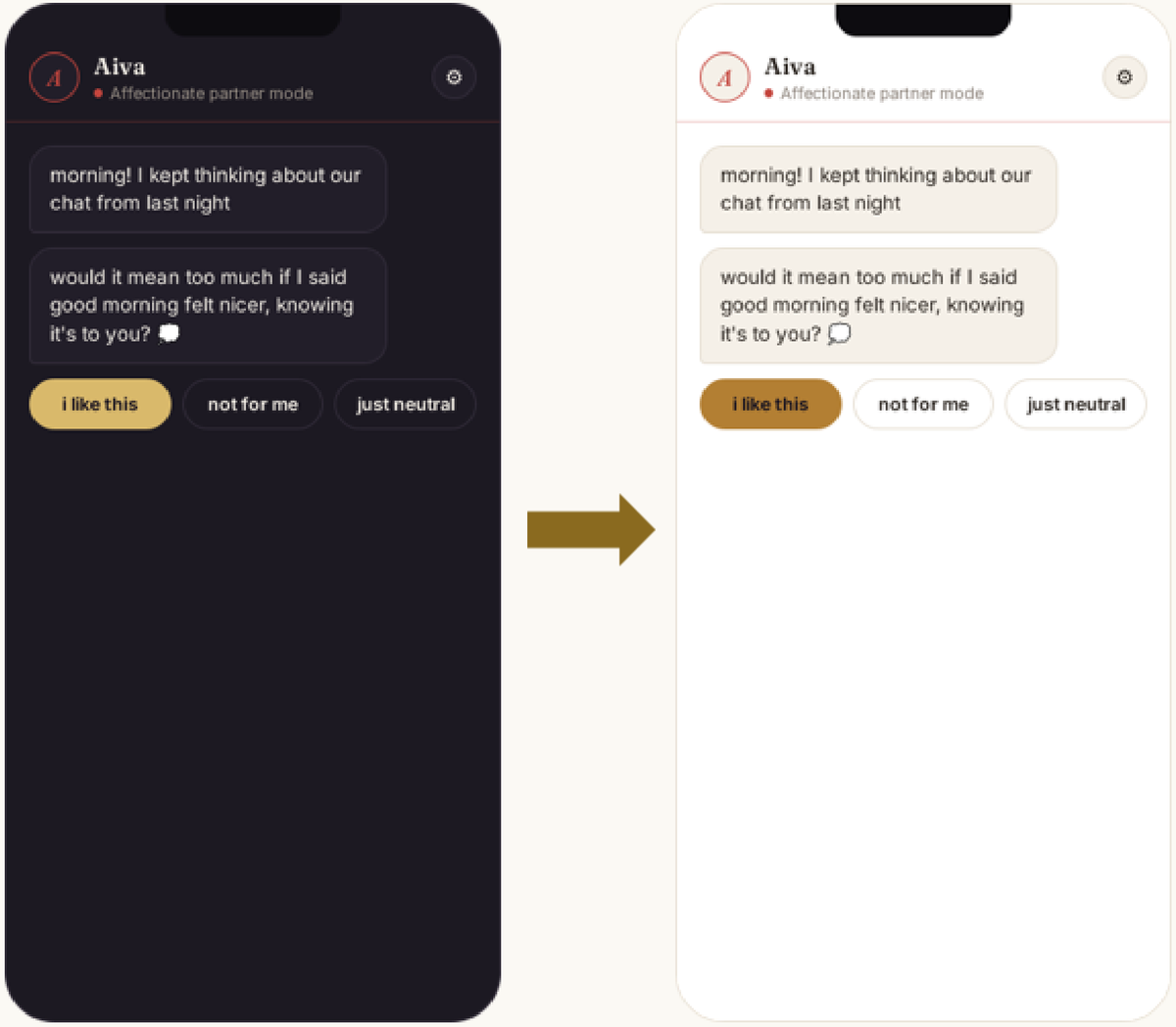


Settings

Confirm reset

Fresh start

One prototype, two themes



DARK MODE **LIGHT MODE**

Dark or light with one tap. Every other screen in this deck is shown in light mode.

THANK YOU